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NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Mississippi Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **48 in every 100**, mark the international share of Mississippi's STEM master's degrees.



The 2026 Mississippi Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Mississippi: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

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Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, and from SEVIS by the Numbers, published by the Department of Homeland Security's Student and Exchange Visitor Program. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Mississippi Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Mississippi's numbers say

1. **International students earn 48% of Mississippi's STEM master's degrees,** 3.9 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 21st of 51 on dependence. The share is 36% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 2.7% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Mississippi awarded 502 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.4% of the U.S. total and 33rd of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed 2.2×, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in computer & info sciences,** where international students earned 87% of master's degrees (381 degrees; U.S. 65%). One STEM field with at least 50 master's graduates is majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** Mississippi ranks 4th of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Mississippi 48%, Arkansas 65%, Nebraska 25%, Connecticut 68%, Kansas 50%.
5. **70% of Mississippi's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 1.5% came from abroad. More students arrived from other states (8.52K) than residents left (3.14K), a net gain of 5.38K; the top destination for those leaving was Alabama.

48%

of the STEM master's degrees Mississippi awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

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SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

164K #34
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · −5.7% since 2015

502 #33
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · 2.19× since 2015

48% #21
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · +21.7 pp since 2015

12% #29
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +3.8 pp since 2015

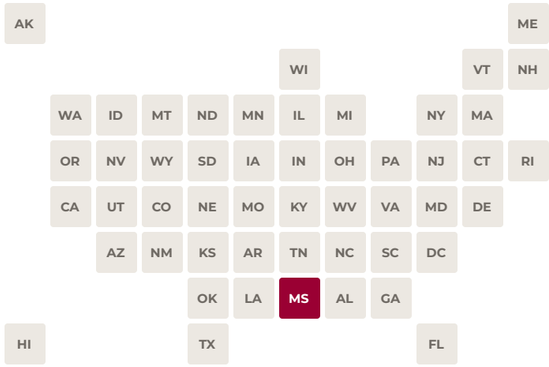
21% #35
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +4.0 pp since 2015

59% #33
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +7.7 pp since 2015

$10.3K #30
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +0.2% since 2015

70% #29
First-time students from in state, 2024
U.S. **–** · −6.8 pp since 2016

$71.7K #50
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −12% since 2016

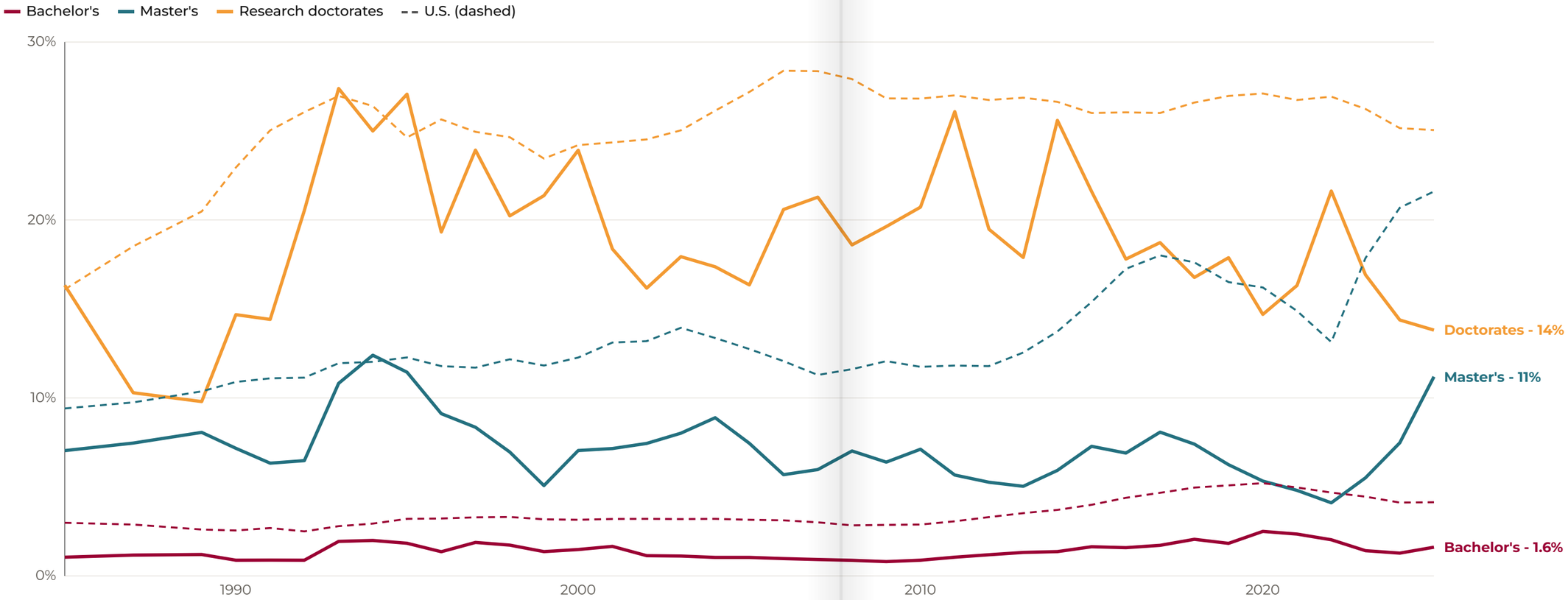


Badges give Mississippi's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

Figure 1 What Share of Mississippi's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025.

International students make up 12% of Mississippi's graduate enrollment and 1.4% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 1.6% of bachelor's, 11% of master's and 14% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 2.7% of STEM bachelor's, 48% of STEM master's and 36% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.4% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 33rd of 51.

12%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **29th** of 51 · +3.8 pp since 2015

11%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **37th** of 51 · +3.9 pp since 2015

48%

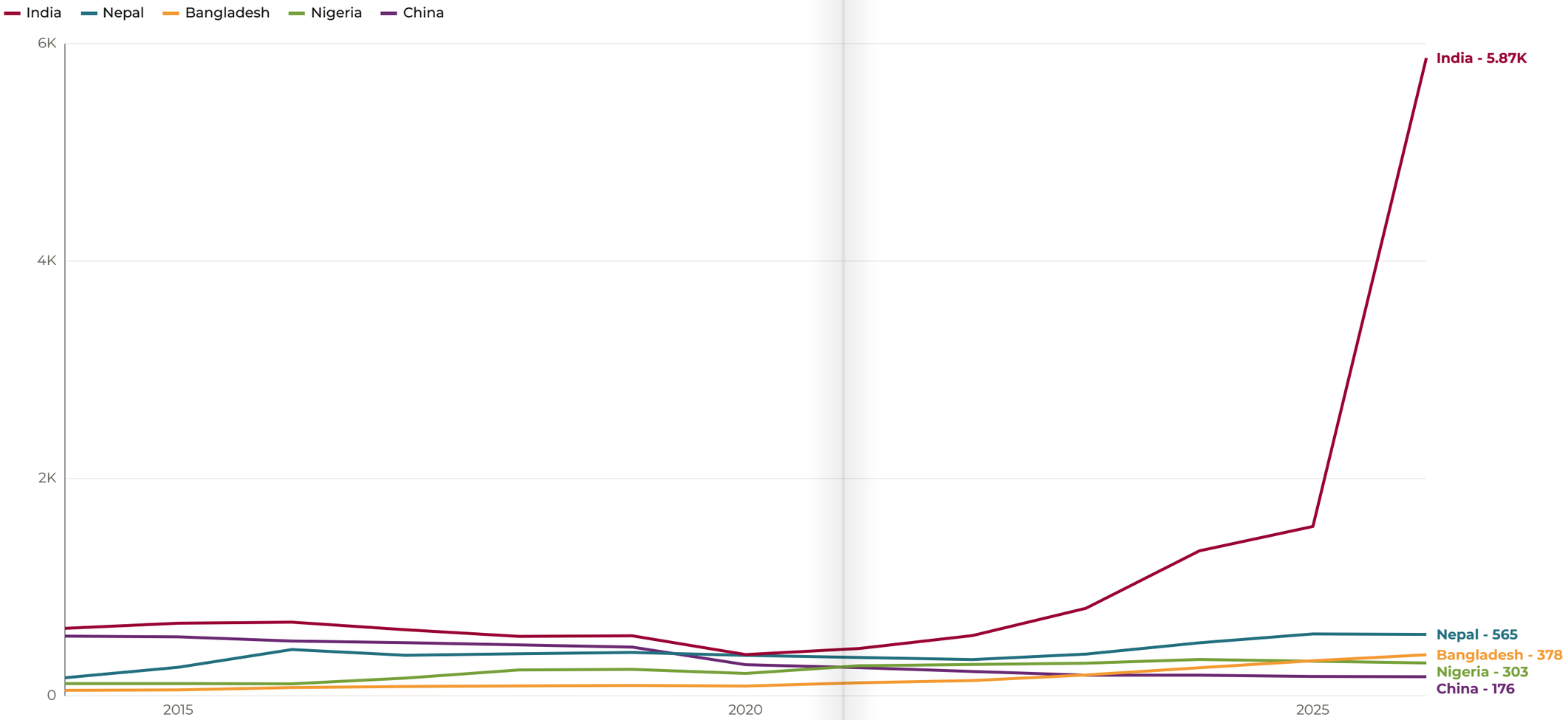
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **21st** of 51 · +21.7 pp since 2015

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Figure 2 Where Do Mississippi's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one snapshot per year (the latest month available), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

In October 2026, Mississippi had 9.84K active international students in SEVIS, 27th of 51. India accounted for 60% of them and Nepal for 5.7%, against 27% and 2.9% nationally.

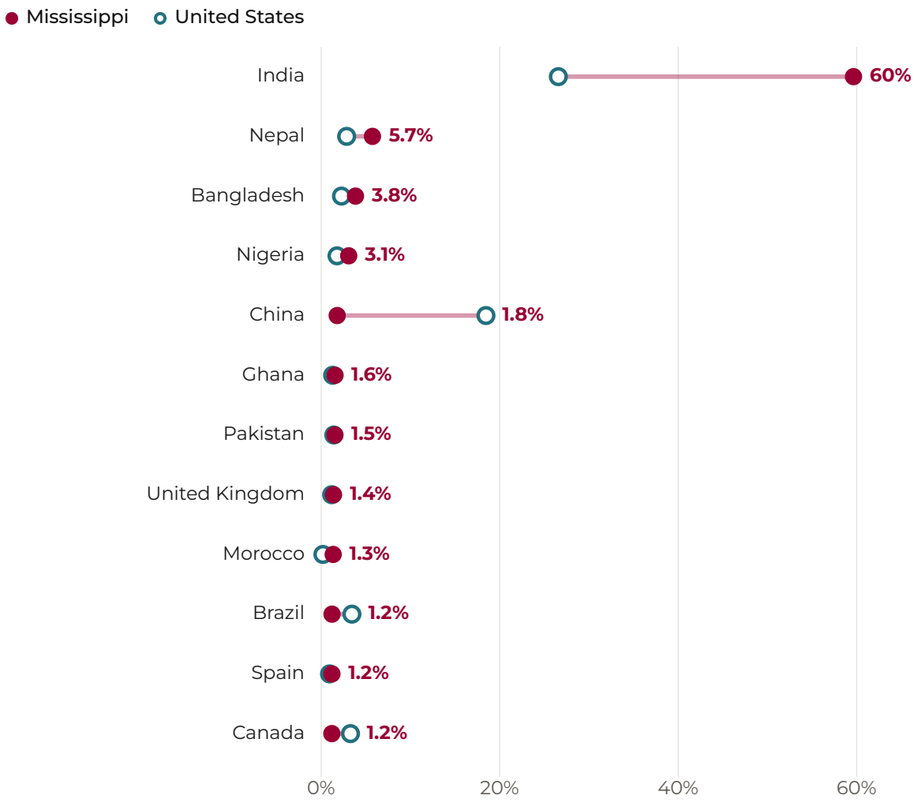
Students came from 141 countries, but the two largest supplied 65%. The state's total is up 195% since 2014.

9.84K
Active international students, October 2026
27th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

60%
From India
U.S. **27%**

25%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

Figure 3 Is Mississippi's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

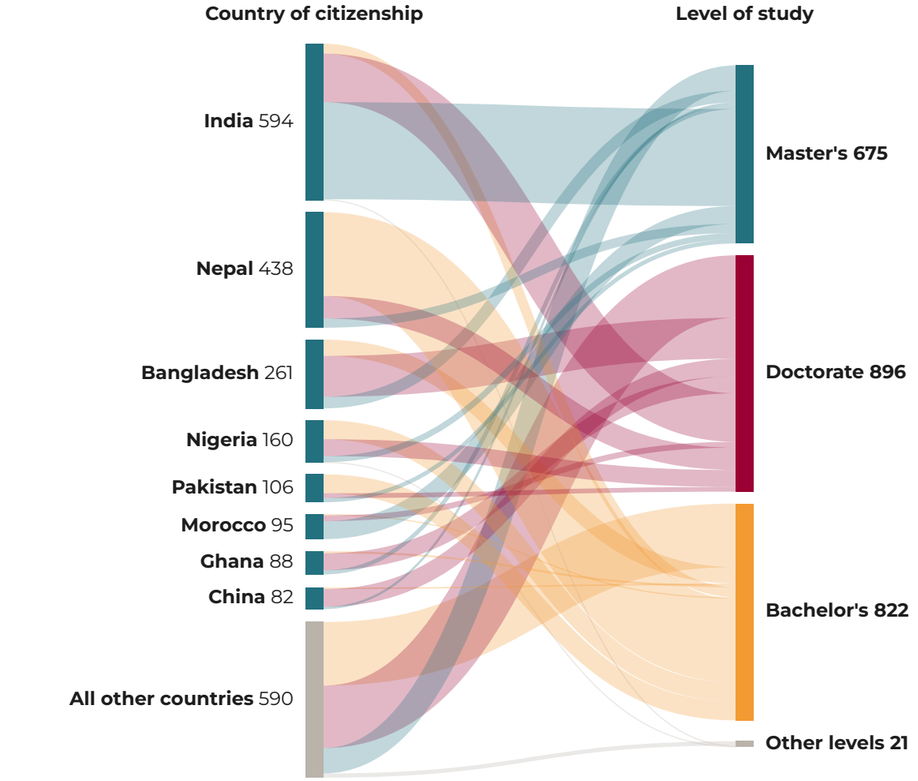
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is one of the 12 countries with the most active F-1 and M-1 student records in Mississippi in October 2026. The filled dot is the country's share of the state's international students; the open dot is its share of all international students in the United States. Students at every level, from secondary school to doctorate, are counted. Yearly counts are the latest month available in each year.

THE NUMBERS

- **All active international students**: 9.84K in October 2026, 27th of 51 states (U.S. 1.19M), up 83% from 5.39K in 2025, and up 165% since 2015 (3.71K).
- **India**: 60% of the state's international students (U.S. 27%); 5.87K students in 2026, up 277% from 1.56K in 2025, and up 779% since 2015 (668).
- **Nepal**: 5.7% of the state's international students (U.S. 2.9%); 565 students in 2026, down 0.9% from 570 in 2025, and up 115% since 2015 (263).
- **Bangladesh**: 3.8% of the state's international students (U.S. 2.3%); 378 students in 2026, up 17% from 323 in 2025, and up 587% since 2015 (55).

Figure 4 Which Countries Supply Mississippi's International STEM Students?



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level, October 2026; the eight largest countries. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

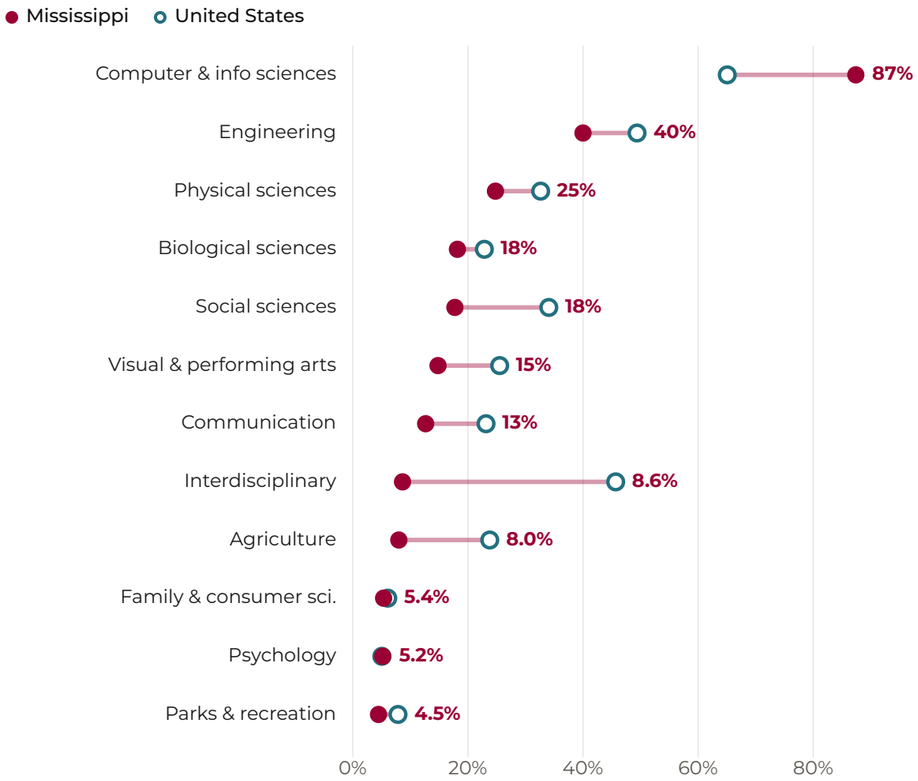
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each band runs from a country of citizenship on the left to a level of study on the right, for international students enrolled in STEM fields in October 2026. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. The eight largest countries are shown and the rest are grouped as all other countries.

THE NUMBERS

- **Share of international students in STEM fields**: 25% in October 2026 (U.S. 63%).
- **Master's level**: 675 students; largest countries India (368), Morocco (68), Bangladesh (44).
- **Doctorate level**: 896 students; largest countries India (184), Bangladesh (155), Nepal (85).
- **Bachelor's level**: 822 students; largest countries Nepal (318), Nigeria (72), Pakistan (72).
- **Active STEM students**: 2.41K in 2026 (U.S. 749K; 40th of 51 states), down 1.1% from 2.44K in 2025, and up 39% since 2015 (1.74K).
- **Share of STEM master's students from India**: 55% in 2026 (U.S. 58%; 31st of 51 states), down 0.7 points from 55% in 2025, and down 1.8 points since 2015 (56%).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in Mississippi in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest international shares**: computer & info sciences 87% (U.S. 65%); engineering 40% (U.S. 49%); physical sciences 25% (U.S. 33%).
- **All master's degrees**: 11% in 2025 (U.S. 22%; 37th of 51 states), up 3.7 points from 7.5% in 2024, and up 3.9 points since 2015 (7.3%).
- **STEM master's degrees**: 48% in 2025 (U.S. 52%; 21st of 51 states), up 15.2 points from 33% in 2024, and up 21.7 points since 2015 (27%).
- **Computer and information sciences master's**: 87% in 2025 (U.S. 65%; 4th of 47 states), up 22.1 points from 65% in 2024, and up 2.4 points since 2015 (85%).

Table 1 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	8.3% / 8.6%	**87% / 65%**	– / 56%
Engineering	2.1% / 7.2%	**40% / 49%**	35% / 55%
Engineering technology	0.6% / 4.5%	**– / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	3.8% / 17%	**– / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	1.0% / 6.0%	**25% / 33%**	42% / 38%
Biological sciences	2.1% / 3.4%	**18% / 23%**	24% / 23%
Natural resources	0.8% / 2.0%	**19% / 17%**	50% / 27%
Architecture	0.0% / 7.3%	**– / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in Mississippi / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

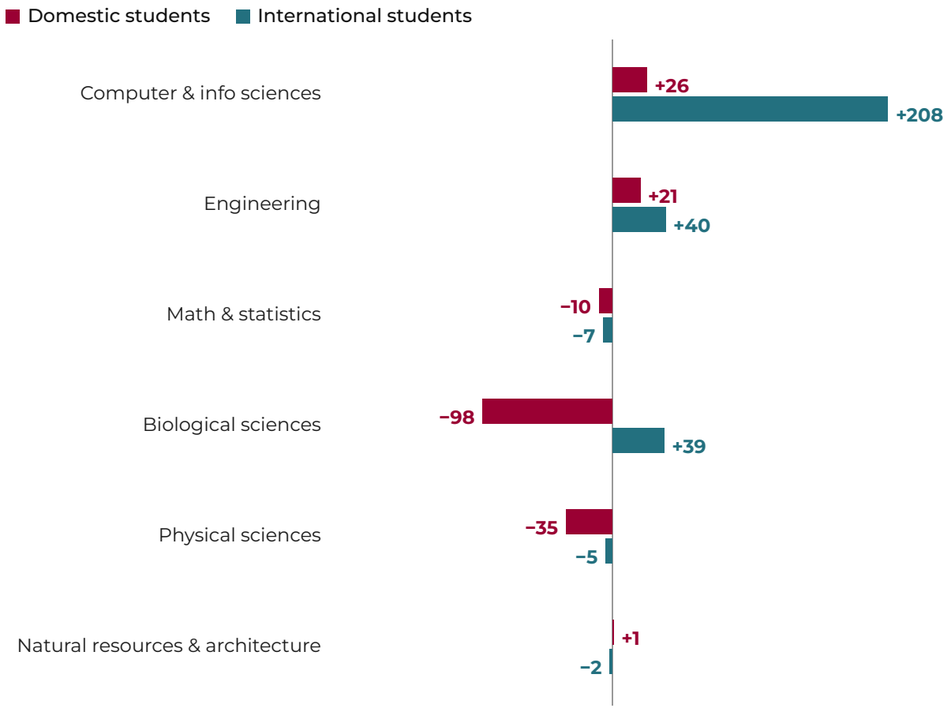
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Mississippi first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest international share among STEM master's fields**: computer & info sciences, 87% (U.S. 65%).
- **STEM fields where international students earn a majority of master's degrees**: 1.
- **International share of STEM bachelor's**: 2.7% in 2025 (U.S. 6.6%; 43rd of 51 states), up 0.8 points from 1.9% in 2024, and down 0.6 points since 2015 (3.4%).
- **International share of STEM master's**: 48% in 2025 (U.S. 52%; 21st of 51 states), up 15.2 points from 33% in 2024, and up 21.7 points since 2015 (27%).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 36% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 38th of 51 states), down 10.2 points from 46% in 2024, and down 14.0 points since 2015 (50%).

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Mississippi between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

THE NUMBERS

- **STEM master's degrees**: 1.04K in 2025, against 863 in 2015: +273 for international students and −95 for domestic students.
- **Computer & info sciences**: +26 for domestic students and +208 for international students.
- **Engineering**: +21 for domestic students and +40 for international students.
- **Math & statistics**: −10 for domestic students and −7 for international students.
- **International students' STEM master's degrees**: 502 in 2025 (U.S. 117K; 33rd of 51 states), up 96% from 256 in 2024, and up 119% since 2015 (229).

Table 2 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	147	**381**	+159%	333	85%	87%
Engineering	137	**198**	+45%	78	28%	39%
Math & statistics	34	**17**	−50%	2	26%	12%
Biological sciences	356	**297**	−17%	54	4.2%	18%
Physical sciences	157	**117**	−25%	29	22%	25%
Natural resources & architecture	32	**31**	−3.1%	6	25%	19%

STEM master's degrees awarded in Mississippi, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Mississippi in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

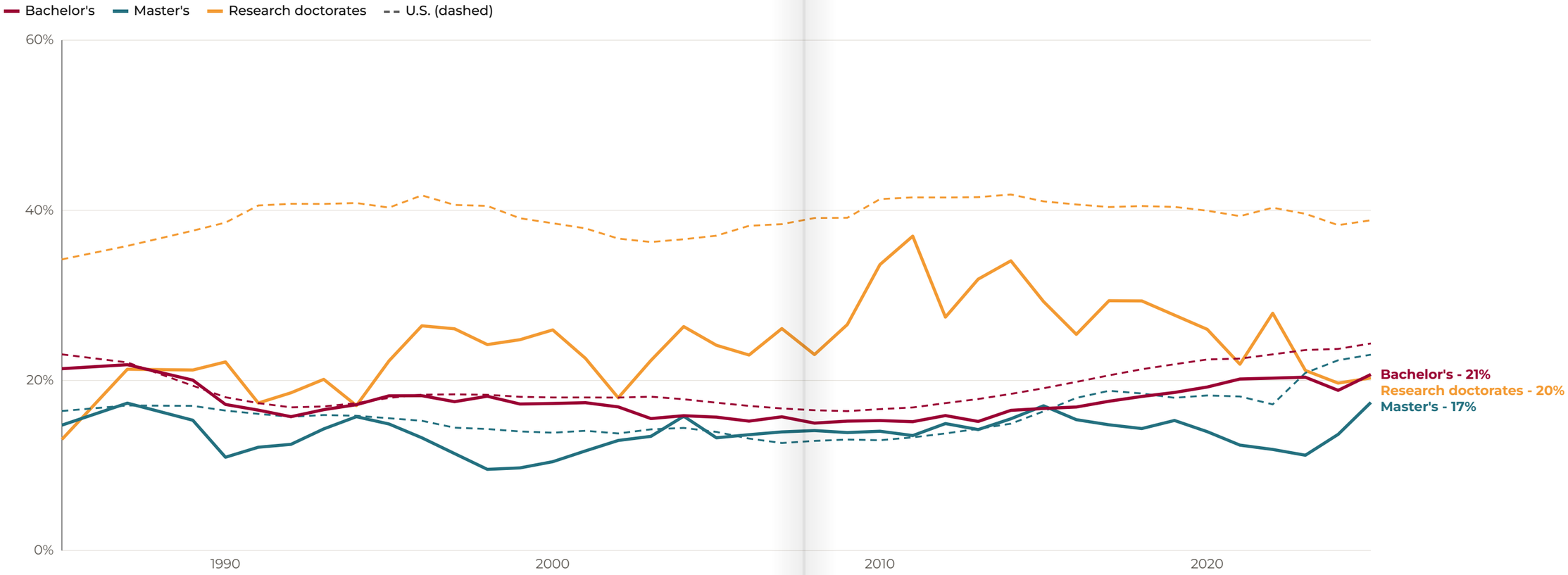
THE NUMBERS

- **STEM share of master's degrees**: 17% in 2025 (U.S. 23%; 32nd of 51 states), up 3.8 points from 14% in 2024, and up 0.4 points since 2015 (17%).
- **Share of all U.S. international STEM master's**: 0.4% in 2025 (33rd of 51 states), up 0.2 points from 0.2% in 2024, and unchanged since 2015 (0.4%).
- **STEM master's degrees per research doctorate**: 5.2 in 2025 (U.S. 6.4; 30th of 51 states), up 0.9 from 4.3 in 2024, and up 0.1 since 2015 (5.1).

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

Figure 7 How Much of Mississippi's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 21% of Mississippi's bachelor's degrees, 17% of its master's and 20% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is up 0.4 points since 2015, and the state ranks 32nd of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 35th of 51.

21%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **35th** of 51 · +4.0 pp since 2015

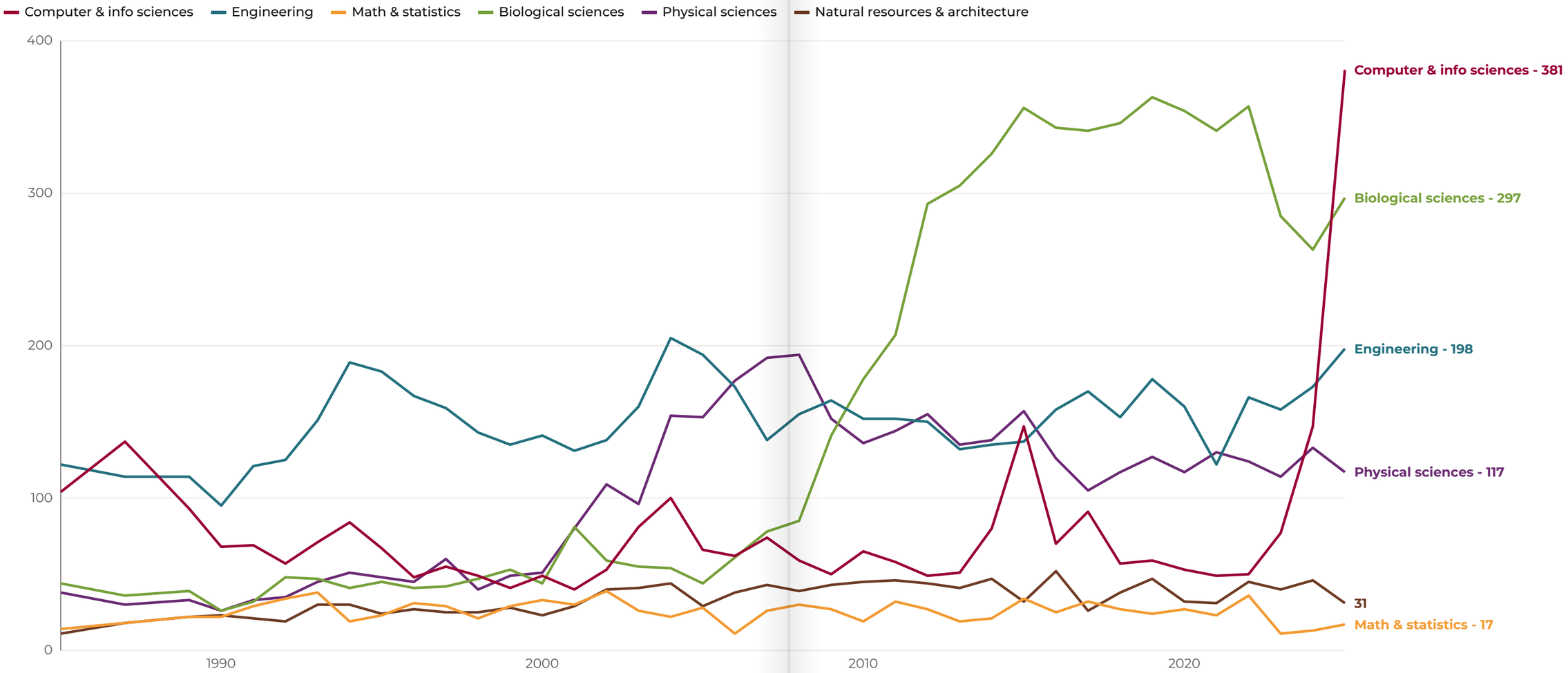
17%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **32nd** of 51 · +0.4 pp since 2015

20%
STEM share of research doctorates, 2025
U.S. **39%** · **49th** of 51 · −9.0 pp since 2015

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Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce Mississippi's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Computer & info sciences produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 381, followed by biological sciences (297) and engineering (198). Master's degrees in computer & info sciences are up 159% since 2015.

International students earned 502 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.4% of the national total (33rd of 51).

502

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **33rd** of 51 · 2.19× since 2015

0.4%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

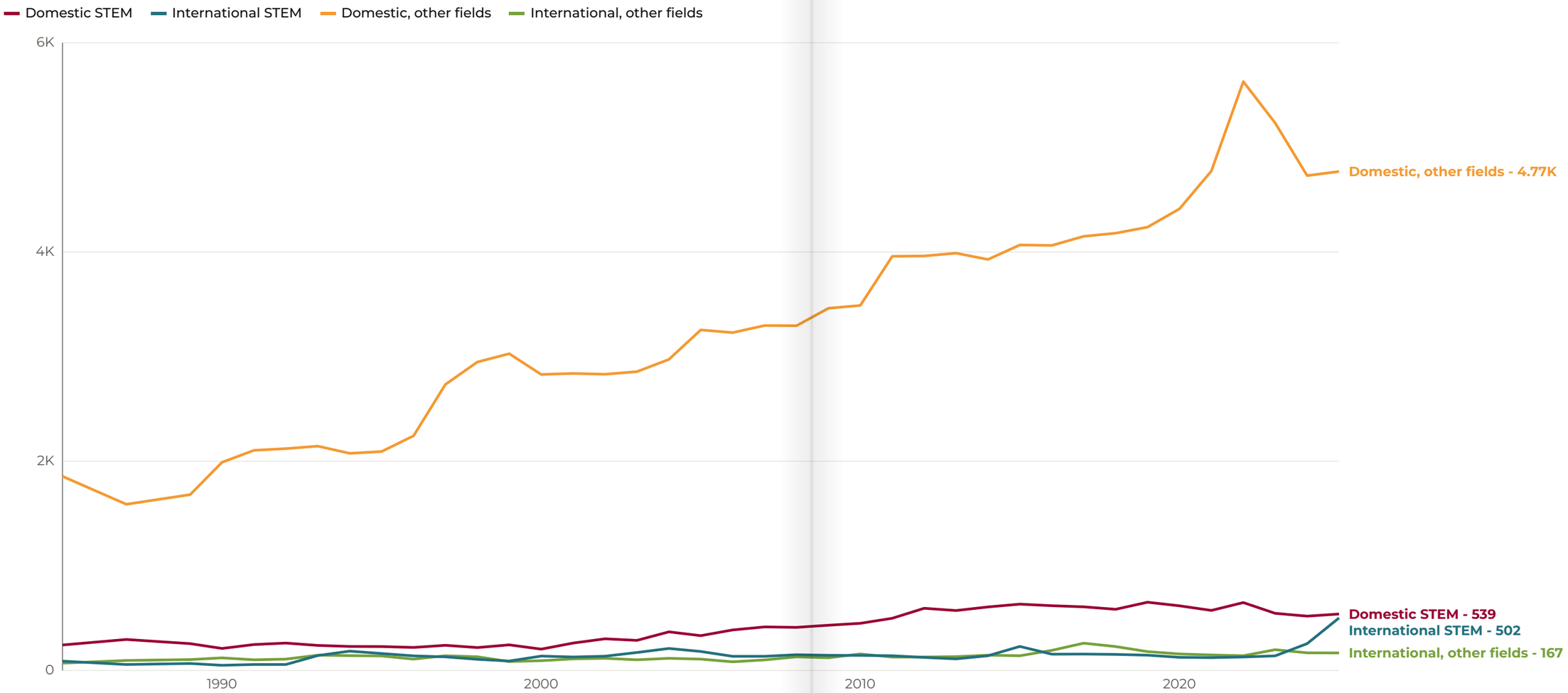
U.S. **100%** · **33rd** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

87%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **4th** of 47 · +2.4 pp since 2015

Figure 9 Who Earns Mississippi's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 273 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and −95 more to domestic students.

International students earn 48% of Mississippi's STEM master's but 3.4% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

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11%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **37th** of 51 · +3.9 pp since 2015

48%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **21st** of 51 · +21.7 pp since 2015

5.2

STEM master's per doctorate, 2025

U.S. **6.4** · **30th** of 51 · +0.1 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest sources and destinations, the rest grouped. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

20.7K residents stayed in Mississippi for college in fall 2024; 8.52K students arrived from other states and 437 from abroad, while 3.14K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 70% of the state's first-time students are residents (U.S. –).

70%

First-time students from in state, 2024

· **29th** of 51 · −6.8 pp since 2016

1.5%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

U.S. **3.1%** · **42nd** of 51 · +0.3 pp since 2016

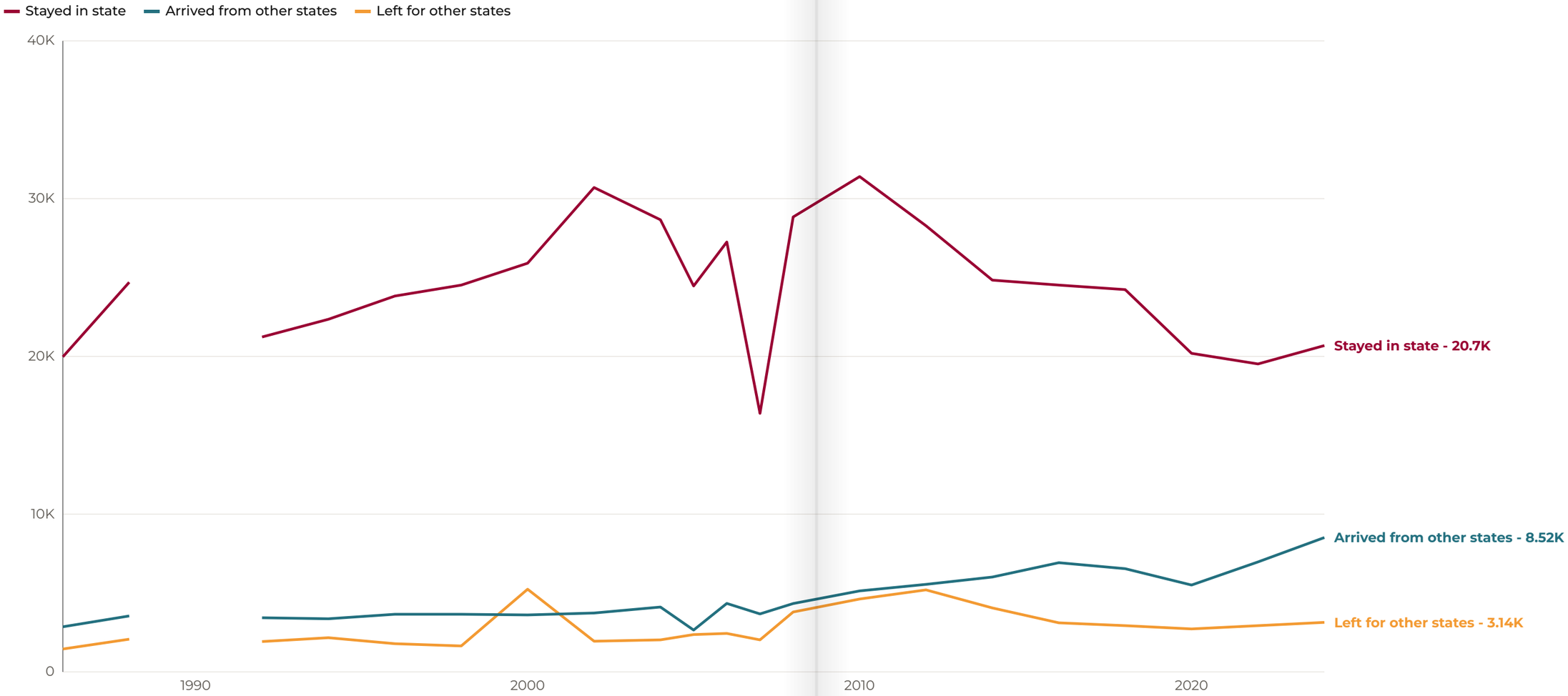
+23

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

· **11th** of 51 · +8.8 since 2016

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Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?

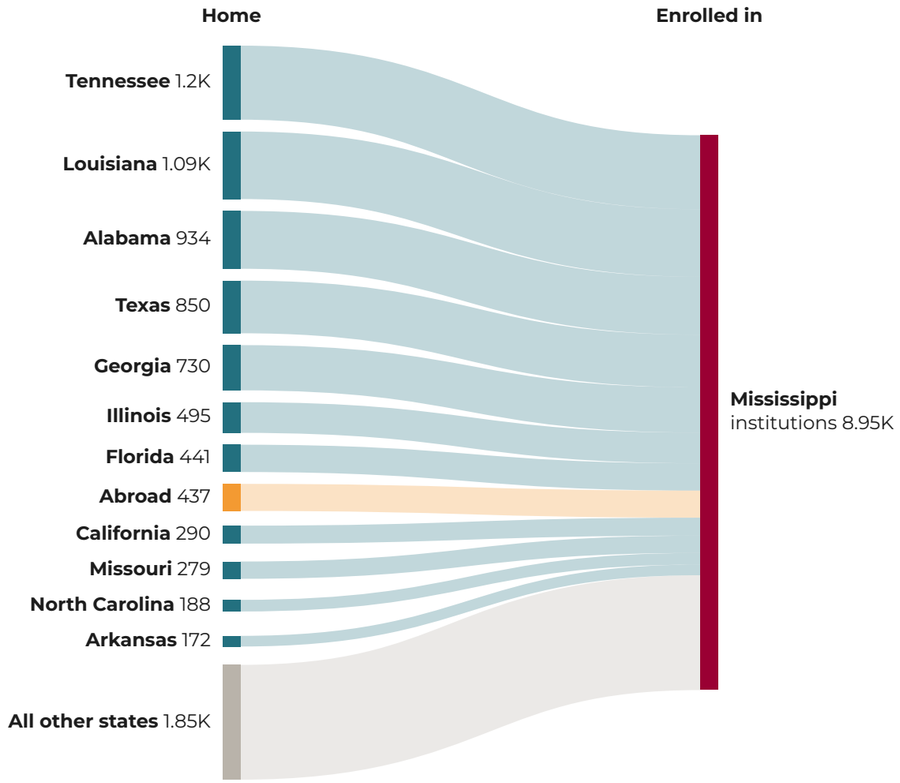


First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is down 16%, arrivals from other states are up 23%, and residents leaving are roughly flat.

Net migration was +23 per 100 resident first-time students (11th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Alabama (598).

Figure 12 Where Do Mississippi's Newcomers Come From?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

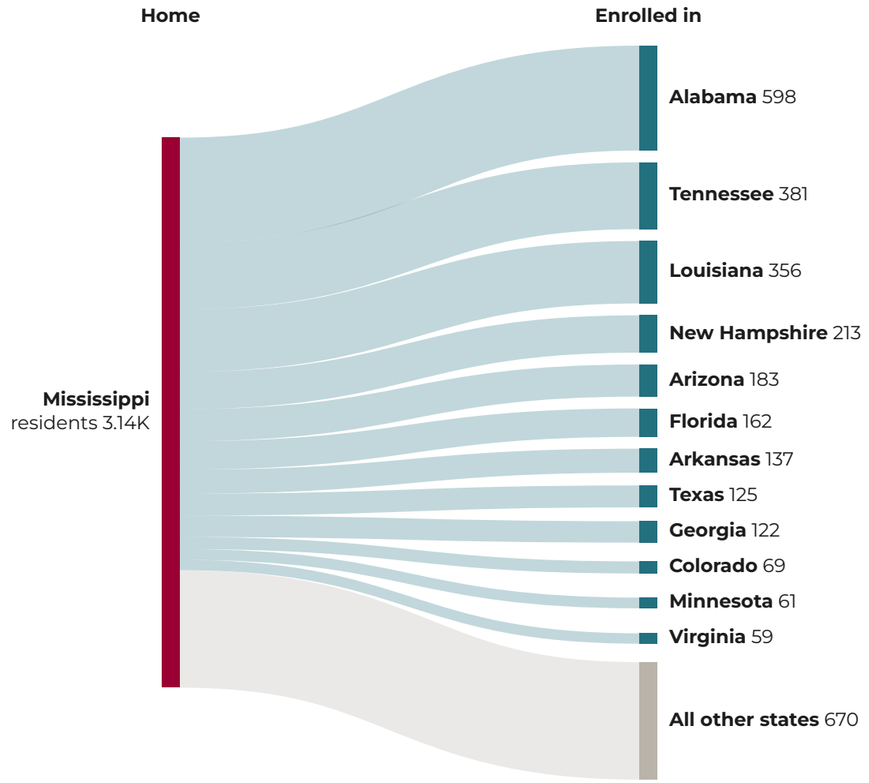
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Mississippi's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

THE NUMBERS

- **Students arriving from other states**: 8.52K in fall 2024, up 22% from 6.97K in fall 2022, and up 23% since fall 2016 (6.92K).
- **Students arriving from abroad**: 437 in fall 2024.
- **Largest home states**: Tennessee (1.2K), Louisiana (1.09K), Alabama (934).
- **Share of first-time students from outside the U.S.**: 1.5% in 2024 (U.S. 3.1%; 42nd of 51 states), up 0.6 points from 0.9% in 2022, and up 0.3 points since 2016 (1.2%).

Figure 13 Where Do Mississippi's Residents Go When They Leave?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The bands show where Mississippi residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

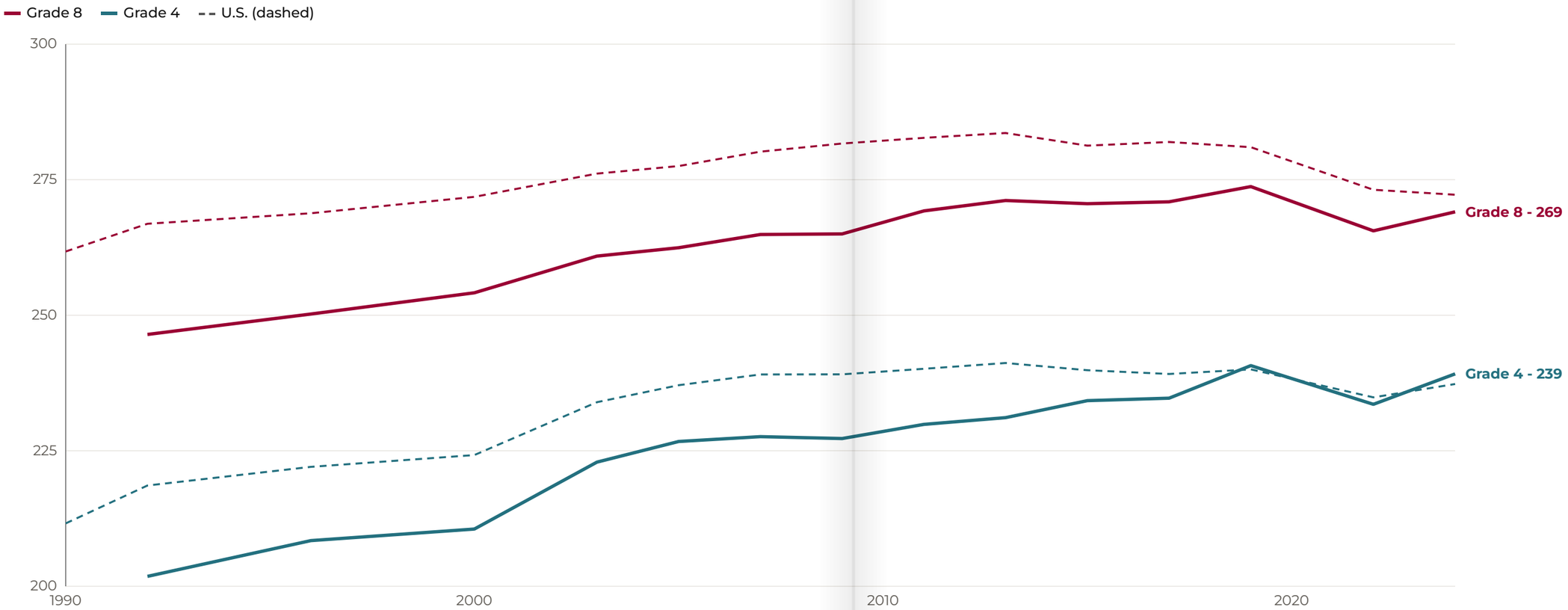
THE NUMBERS

- **Residents leaving for other states**: 3.14K in fall 2024, up 7.0% from 2.93K in fall 2022, and up 0.9% since fall 2016 (3.11K).
- **Residents staying in the state**: 20.7K in fall 2024, up 5.9% from 19.5K in fall 2022, and down 16% since fall 2016 (24.5K).
- **Largest destinations**: Alabama (598), Tennessee (381), Louisiana (356).
- **Net migration per 100 resident first-time students**: +23 in 2024 (11th of 51 states), up 5 from +18 in 2022, and up 9 since 2016 (+14).

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Mississippi's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, National Assessment of Educational Progress.

The talent pipeline starts in school. Mississippi's eighth graders averaged 269 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 35th of 51 among the states.

22% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.

269

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **35th** of 51 · −1.5 since 2015

22%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **40th** of 51 · −0.2 pp since 2015

253

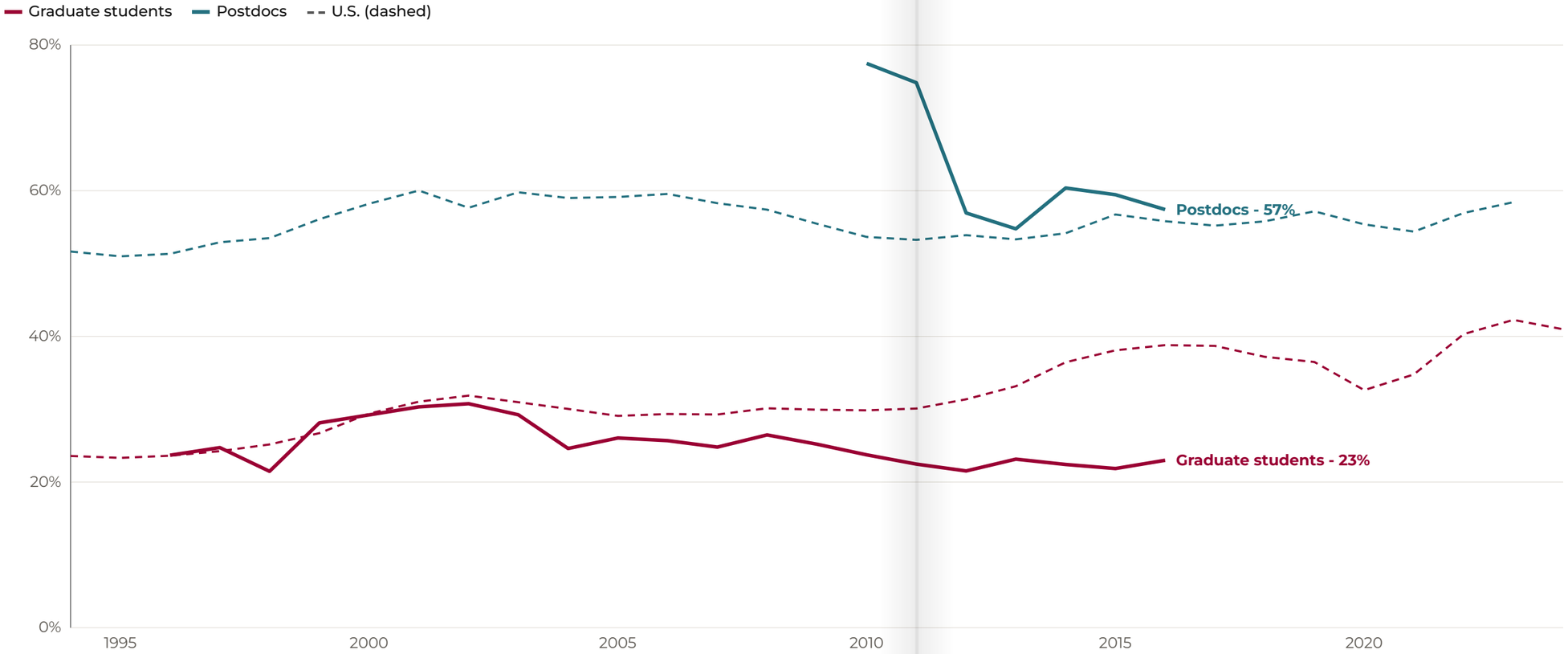
Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **257** · **41st** of 51 · +1.5 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Figure 15 How Many of Mississippi's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temporary Visas?



Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's state; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 23% of Mississippi's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 43rd of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 57% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 469 research doctorates in 2025, 0.8% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

23%
S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **39%** · **43rd** of 51 · +1.1 pp since 2015

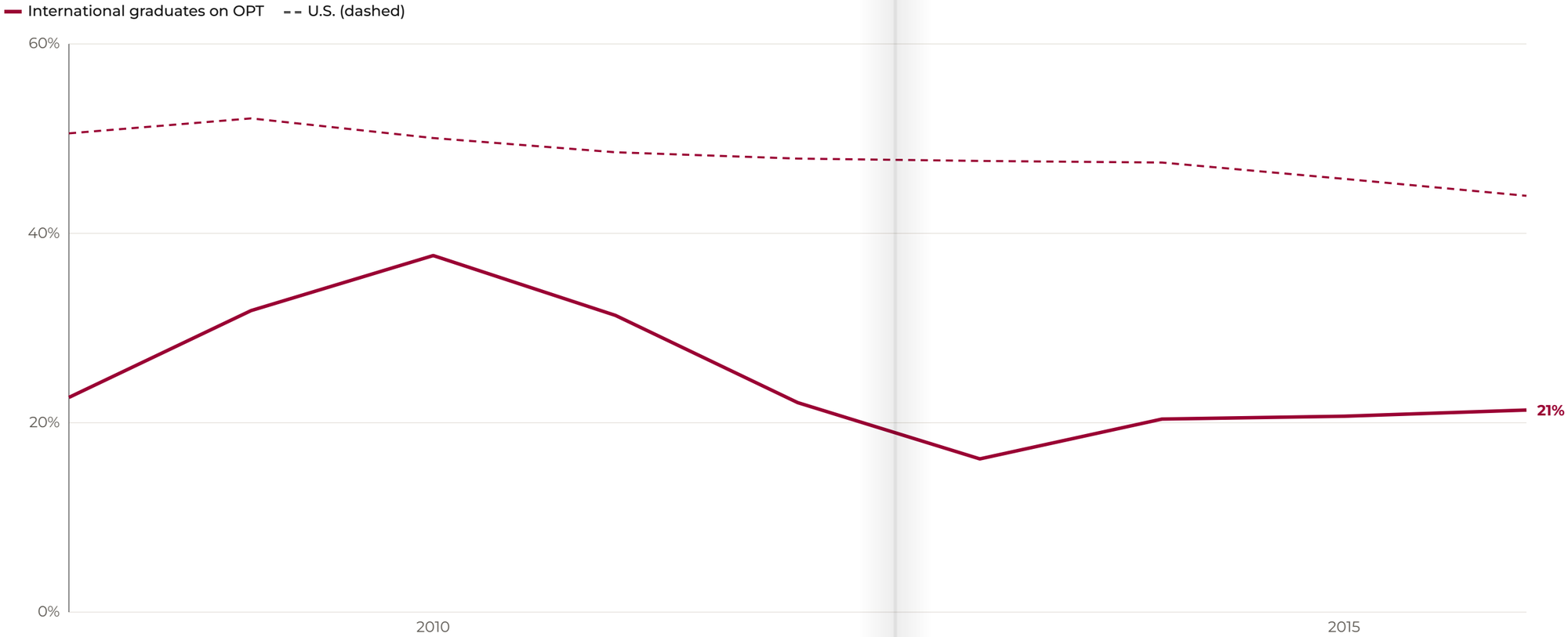
57%
S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **56%** · **19th** of 51 · −2.1 pp since 2015

469
Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025
U.S. **59K** · **33rd** of 51 · +5.2% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Figure 16 How Many of Mississippi's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or participating states dashed.

Mississippi's institutions do not take part in the Census Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes program, so in-state employment of its graduates is not published.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 21% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). Through migration between states, the state lost 1.1 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

21%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **46th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

−1.1

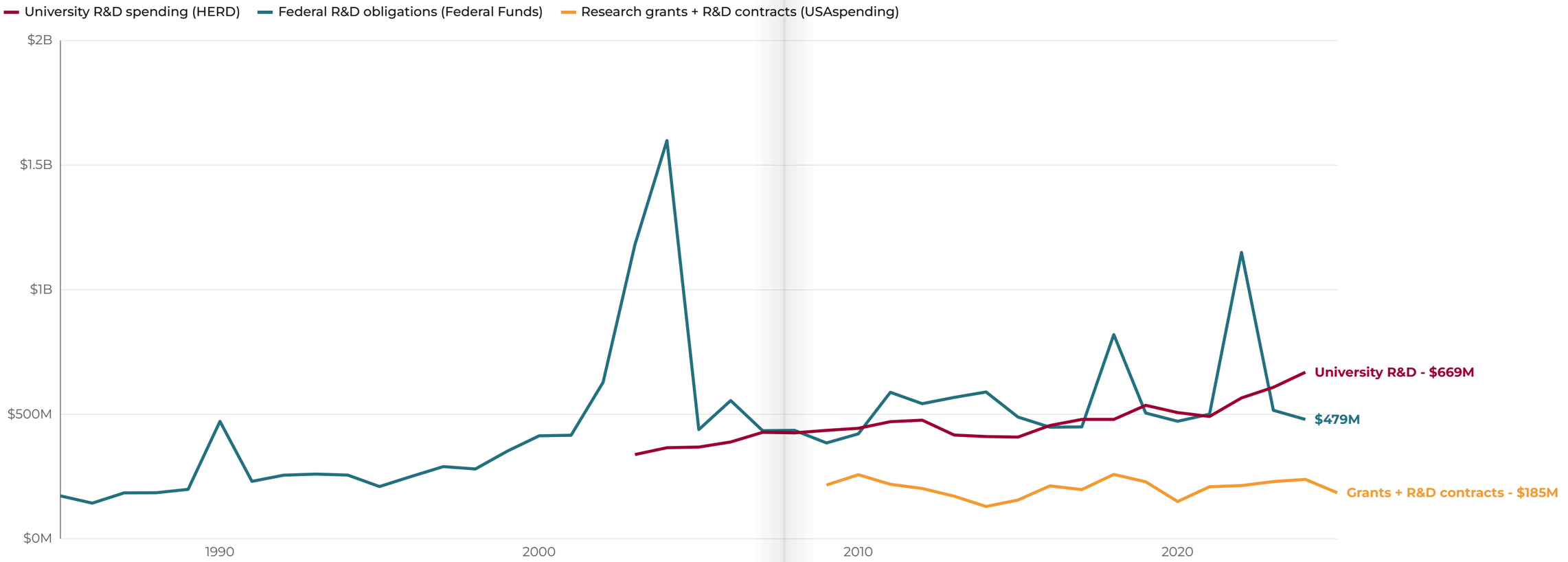
Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

· **30th** of 51 · +8.8 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into Mississippi?



Millions of nominal dollars, fiscal years. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

Mississippi's universities spent $669M on research and development in FY2024, 35th of 51 among the states; 53% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $479M for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

$669M
University R&D spending, 2024
U.S. **$118B** · **35th** of 51 · +64% since 2015

53%
Federal share of university R&D, 2024
U.S. **55%** · **24th** of 51 · +5.0 pp since 2015

$479M
Federal R&D obligations, 2024
U.S. **$193B** · **39th** of 51 · −2.0% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Mississippi Generate?



Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 931 H-1B positions at Mississippi worksites in FY2025, 42nd of 51 among the states. A labor certification comes before the petition, so this overstates hires; USCIS approved 169 new H-1B petitions from employers in the state in FY2026.

DOL certified 163 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 8.2% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

931

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **42nd** of 51 · −3.7% since 2015

163

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

U.S. **138K** · **44th** of 51 · +83% since 2015

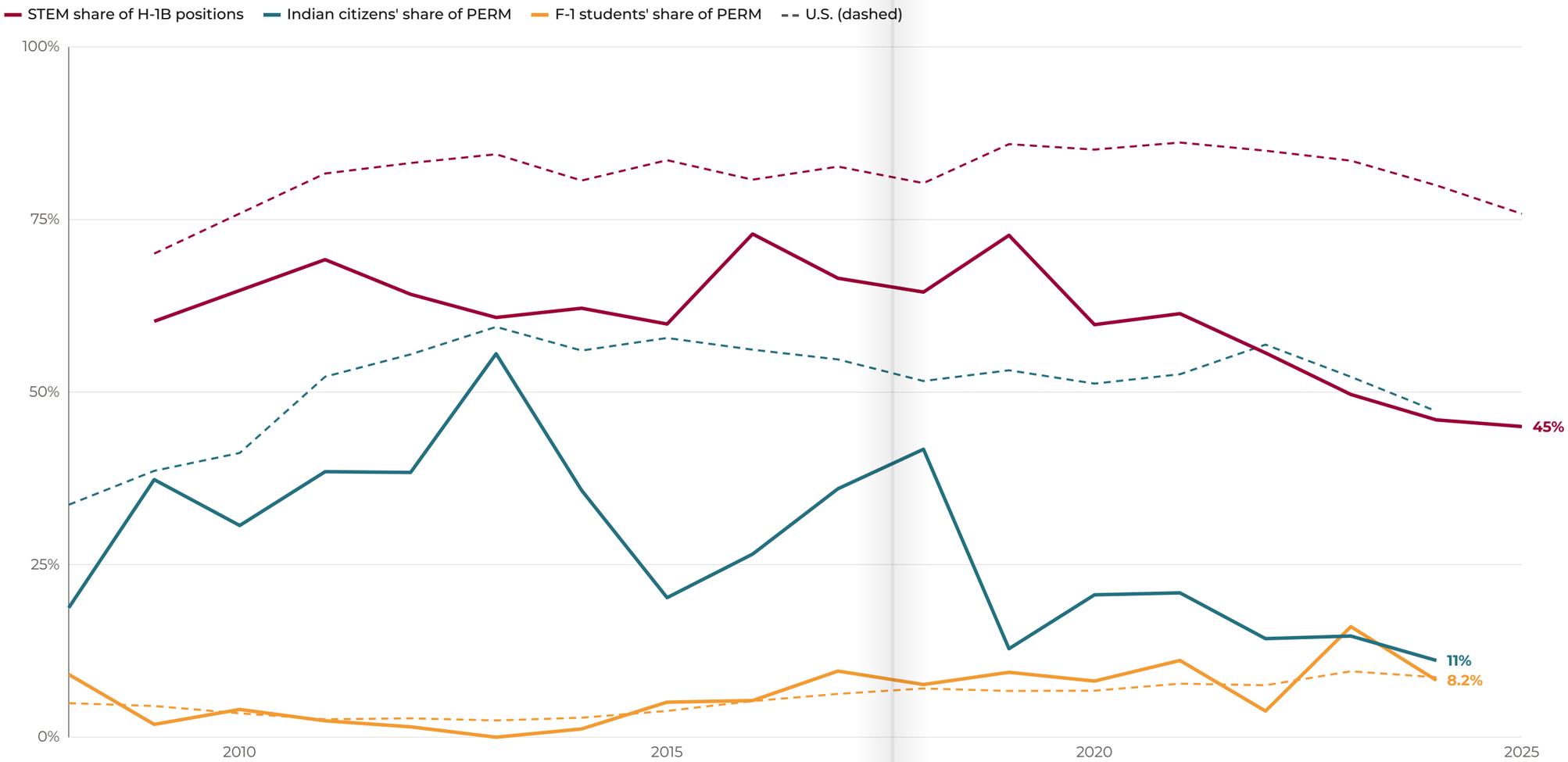
8.2%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **30th** of 51 · +3.2 pp since 2015

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Figure 19 Who Holds Mississippi's Skilled-Visa Jobs?



State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

45% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 11% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

45%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **43rd** of 51 · −14.9 pp since 2015

11%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **46th** of 51 · −9.1 pp since 2015

$78K

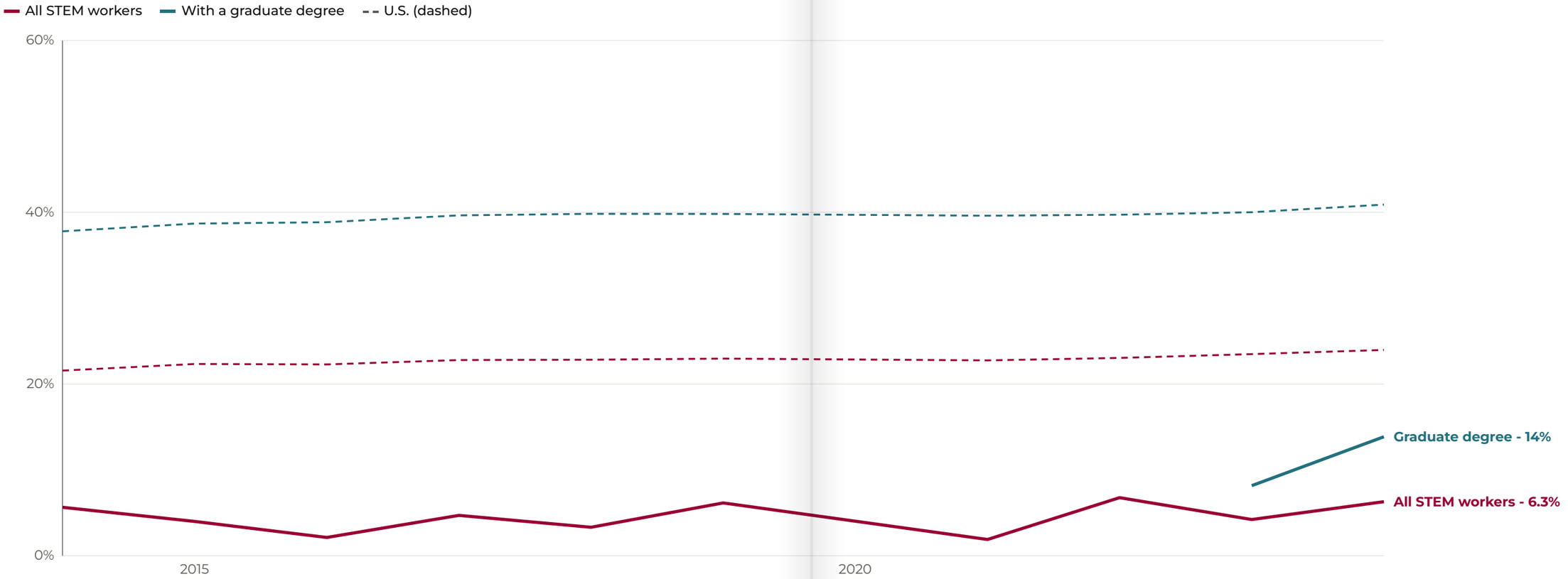
Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

U.S. **$119K** · **47th** of 51 · +19% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

Figure 20 How Much of Mississippi's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resting on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey.

In 2024, 6.3% of the people working in STEM occupations in Mississippi were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 46th of 51).

The share rises with education: 14% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%). 3.8% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.

6.3%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **46th** of 51 · +2.3 pp since 2015

14%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **43rd** of 44 · +5.7 pp since 2023

3.8%

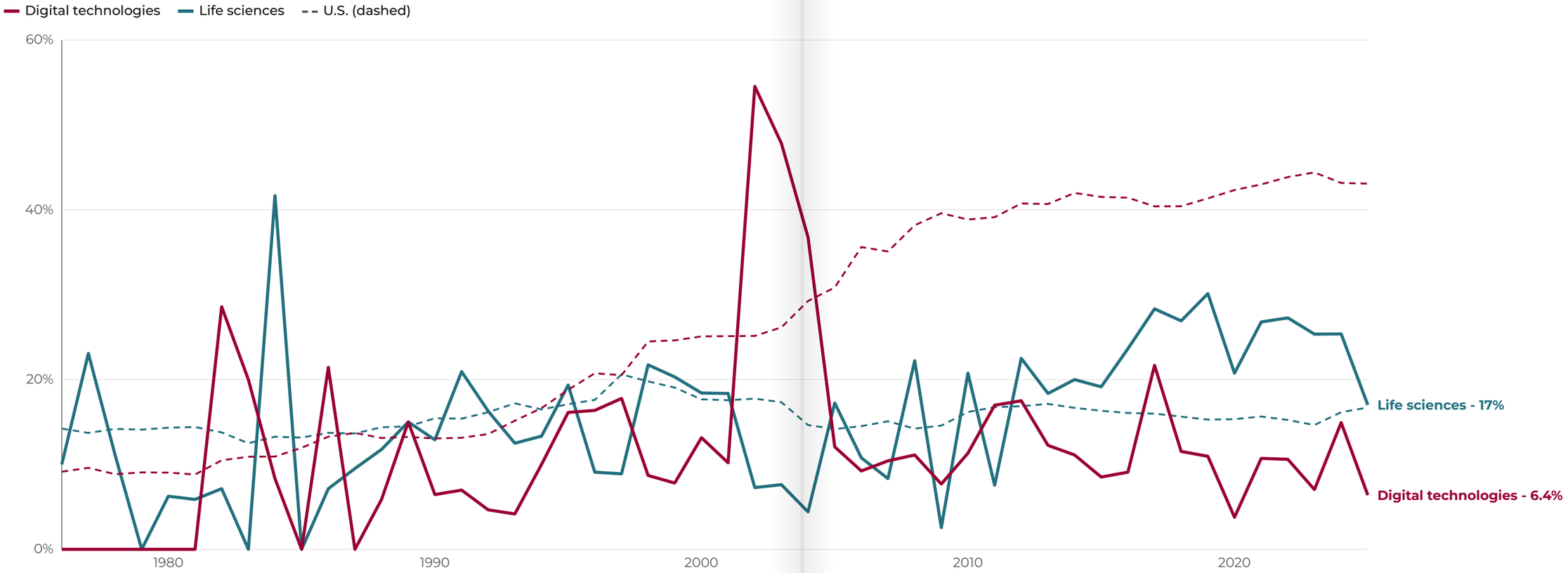
Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **11%** · **45th** of 51 · +1.3 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does Mississippi Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

Organizations and people in Mississippi were granted 43 U.S. patents in 2025, 0.0% of all patents with a U.S. owner (48th of 51).

6.4% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 17% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).

43

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **48th** of 51 · −8.6% since 2015

6.4%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **51st** of 51 · −2.1 pp since 2015

17%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

U.S. **17%** · **25th** of 51 · −2.1 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

The four states closest in size are Arkansas, Nebraska, Connecticut, Kansas. Mississippi ranks 4th of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Connecticut is the most dependent at 68%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are Mississippi and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?

Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

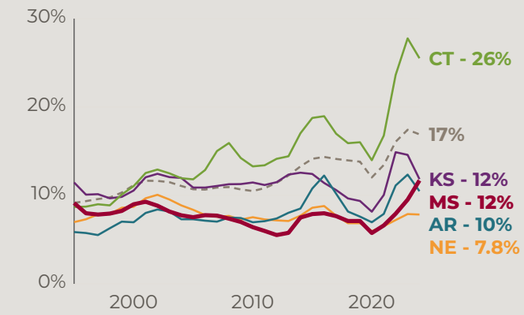
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Table 3 How Does Mississippi Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	MS	AR	NE	CT	KS	U.S.
Students enrolled	**164K**	162K	140K	194K	196K	19.7M
Graduate share of students	**13%**	16%	18%	22%	14%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's	**21%**	17%	20%	20%	20%	24%
STEM share of master's	**17%**	22%	13%	27%	17%	23%
International STEM master's	**502**	918	170	2.83K	629	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's	**0.4%**	0.8%	0.1%	2.4%	0.5%	100%
Int. share of STEM master's	**48%**	65%	25%	68%	50%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates	**36%**	58%	38%	47%	52%	43%
Int. share of grad students	**12%**	10%	7.8%	26%	12%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment	**1.4%**	2.3%	2.1%	3.0%	3.6%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate	**59%**	54%	61%	69%	58%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year	**$9.66K**	$9.24K	$9.29K	$16.6K	$9.87K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student	**$10.3K**	$9.05K	$14.2K	$11.9K	$12K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary	**$71.7K**	$70.1K	$88.5K	$133K	$80.1K	$106K
First-time students from in state	**70%**	70%	77%	61%	68%	–
Net migration per 100 residents	**+23**	+16	+2	−5	+16	–

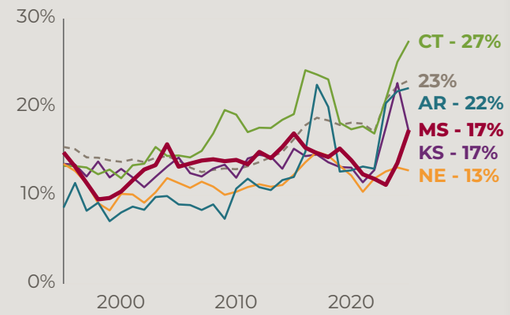
Latest year for each measure. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



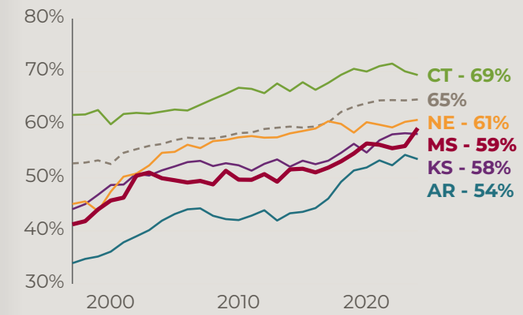
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



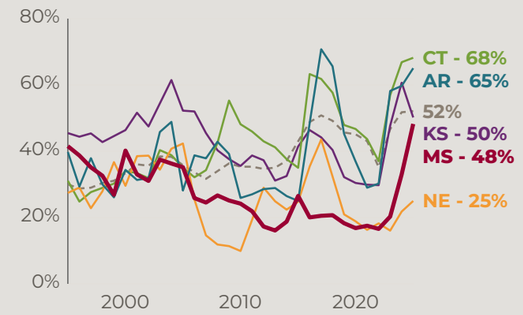
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM master's

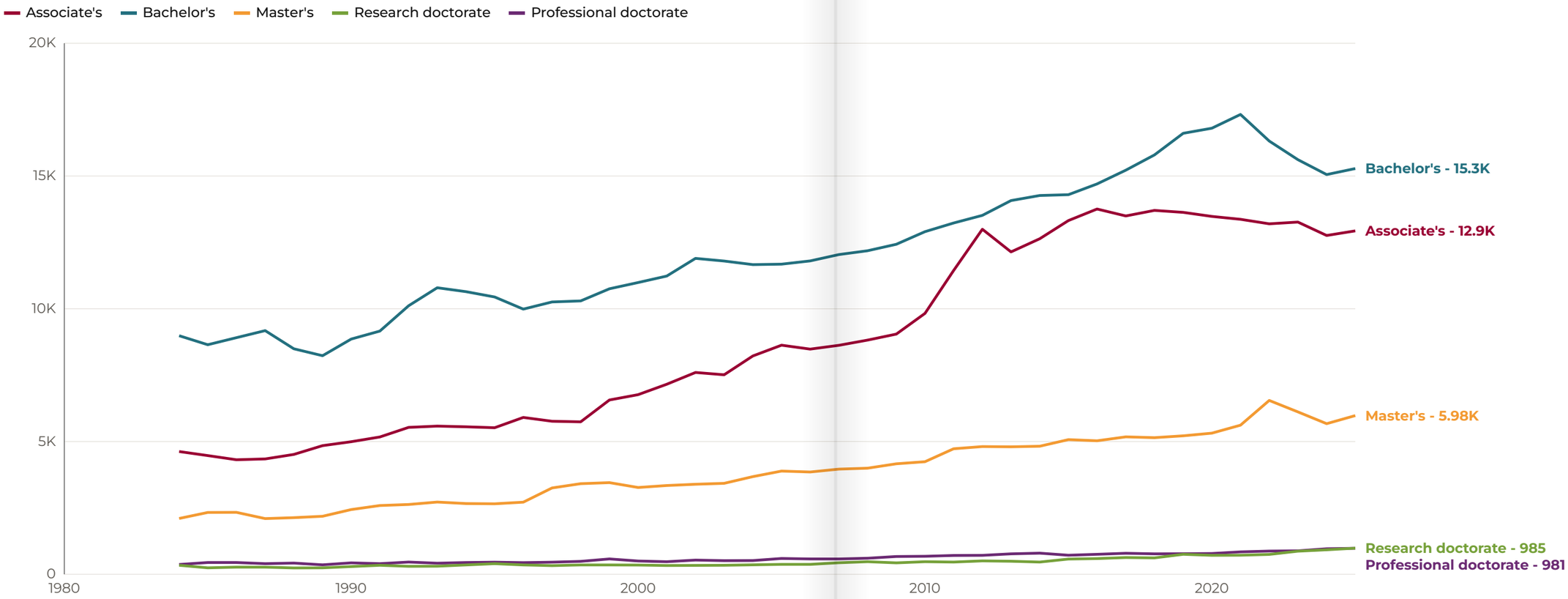


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does Mississippi Award?



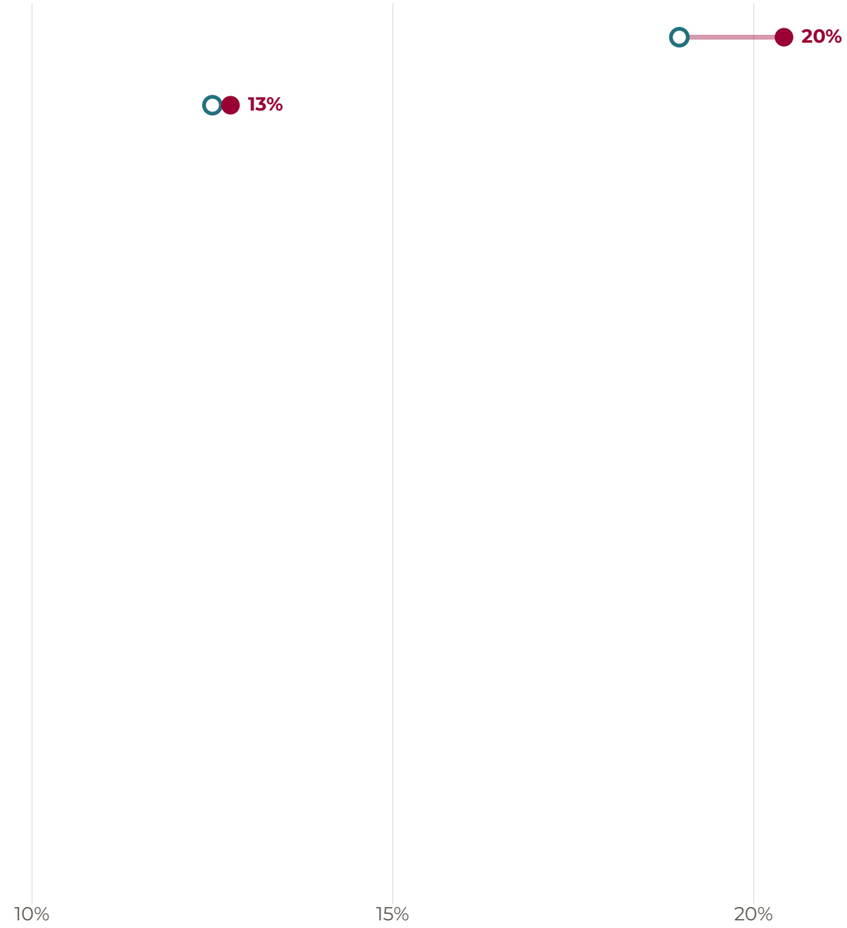
Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, Mississippi's institutions awarded 12.9K associate's degrees, 15.3K bachelor's degrees, 5.98K master's degrees, 985 research doctorate degrees, 981 professional doctorate degrees.

Since 2015: associate's down 3%; bachelor's up 7%; master's up 18%; research doctorate up 72%; professional doctorate up 36%. The state awards 10.8 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

Figure 28 What Do Mississippi's Bachelor's Graduates Study?





Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Mississippi's largest bachelor's fields are business (20%; U.S. 19%), health professions (13%; U.S. 13%), education (7.5%; U.S. 4.3%).

Relative to the nation, Mississippi's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in agriculture (1.97× the U.S. share), parks & recreation (1.94× the U.S. share), education (1.74× the U.S. share).

2.9%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **49th** of 51 · +1.8 pp since 2015

7.9%
Bachelor's in engineering, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **14th** of 51 · +2.0 pp since 2015

20%
Bachelor's in business, 2025
U.S. **19%** · **21st** of 51 · +1.8 pp since 2015

Figure 29 What Do Mississippi's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Mississippi's largest master's fields are education (30%; U.S. 15%), business (20%; U.S. 21%), health professions (11%; U.S. 15%).

International students earn 11% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 17% of them.

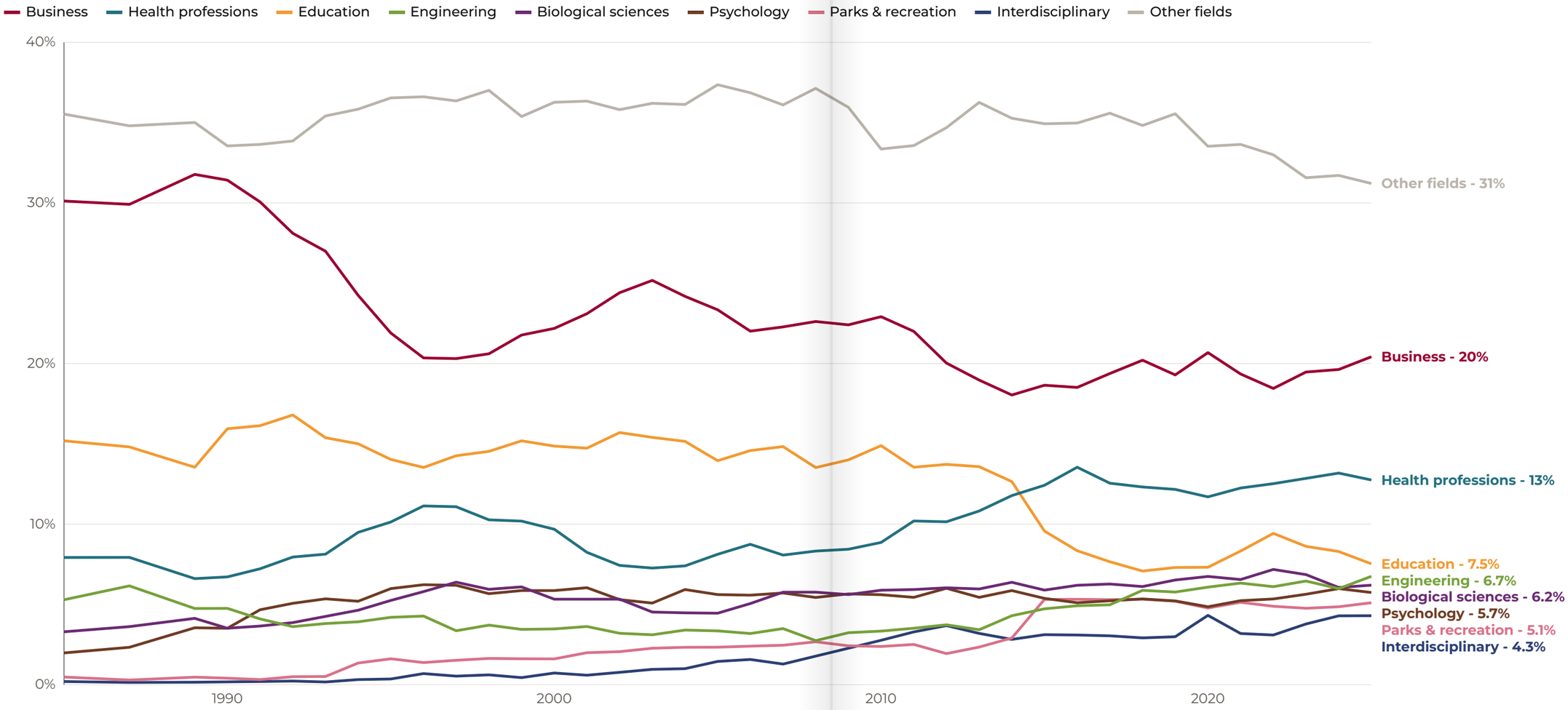
17%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **32nd** of 51 · +0.4 pp since 2015

11%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **37th** of 51 · +3.9 pp since 2015

87%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **4th** of 47 · +2.4 pp since 2015

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Figure 30 How Has Mississippi's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, engineering has gained the most ground, 2.0 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while education lost the most (2.0 points).

The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

Table 4 Where Is Mississippi Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Agriculture	**1.97**	2.0%	1.0%	309
Parks & recreation	**1.94**	5.1%	2.6%	780
Education	**1.74**	7.5%	4.3%	1.15K
Architecture	**1.72**	1.0%	0.6%	149
Interdisciplinary	**1.50**	4.3%	2.9%	657
Liberal arts	**1.43**	2.6%	1.8%	397
Public administration	**1.42**	2.1%	1.5%	318
Engineering technology	**1.32**	1.2%	0.9%	180
Family & consumer sci.	**1.22**	1.0%	0.8%	153
Engineering	**1.15**	6.7%	5.9%	1.03K

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

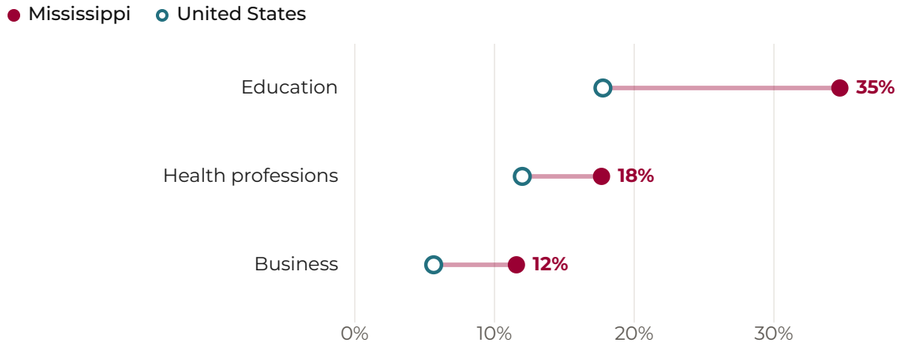
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The location quotient divides a field's share of Mississippi's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the ten fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest location quotients**: agriculture 1.97 (2.0% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 1.0%); parks & recreation 1.94 (5.1% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 2.6%); education 1.74 (7.5% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 4.3%).
- **STEM share of bachelor's degrees**: 21% in 2025 (U.S. 24%; 35th of 51 states), up 1.9 points from 19% in 2024, and up 4.0 points since 2015 (17%).
- **Computer and information sciences**: 2.9% in 2025 (U.S. 6.9%; 49th of 51 states), up 0.7 points from 2.2% in 2024, and up 1.8 points since 2015 (1.1%).
- **Engineering**: 7.9% in 2025 (U.S. 6.8%; 14th of 51 states), up 0.6 points from 7.3% in 2024, and up 2.0 points since 2015 (5.9%).

Figure 31 What Do Mississippi's Doctoral Graduates Study?



Share of research doctorates by field, 2025; fields with 20+ doctorates. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is a field's share of the research doctorates awarded in Mississippi in 2025 (filled dot), against its share nationally (open dot), for the ten largest fields with at least 20 doctorates. Research doctorates exclude professional doctorates such as the M.D. and J.D.

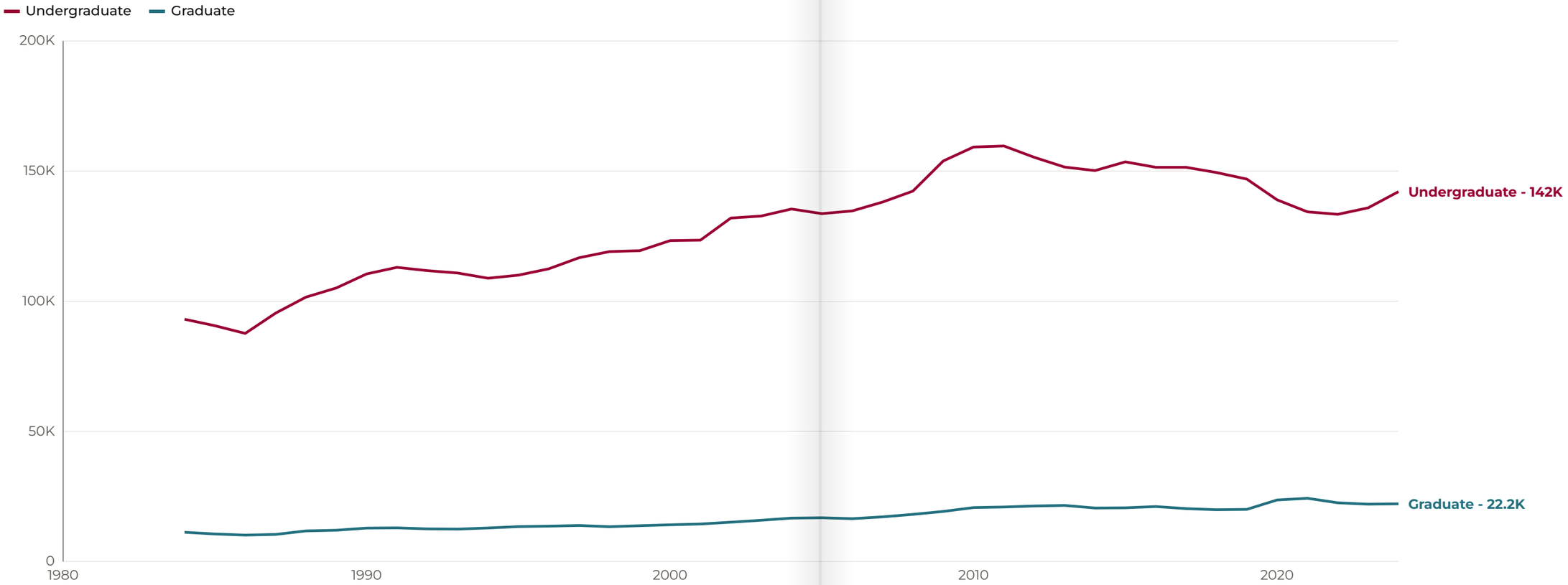
THE NUMBERS

- **Largest doctoral fields**: education 35% (U.S. 18%); health professions 18% (U.S. 12%); business 12% (U.S. 5.6%).
- **STEM share of research doctorates**: 20% in 2025 (U.S. 39%; 49th of 51 states), up 0.6 points from 20% in 2024, and down 9.0 points since 2015 (29%).
- **International share of research doctorates**: 14% in 2025 (U.S. 25%; 47th of 51 states), down 0.6 points from 14% in 2024, and down 7.8 points since 2015 (22%).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 36% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 38th of 51 states), down 10.2 points from 46% in 2024, and down 14.0 points since 2015 (50%).

SECTION 13

Students and Money

Figure 32 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Mississippi enrolled 142K undergraduates and 22.2K graduate students, 164K in all (34th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 7% since 2015 and graduate enrollment up 7% since 2015. Graduate students are 13% of all students (U.S. 17%).

164K

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **34th** of 51 · −5.7% since 2015

13%

Graduate share of students, 2024

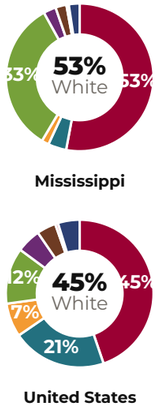
U.S. **17%** · **35th** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

28%

Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **47th** of 51 · +4.4 pp since 2015

Figure 33 Who Enrolls in Mississippi?



	Mississippi	United States
White	**53%**	45%
Hispanic	**4.0%**	21%
Asian / Pacific Islander	**1.6%**	7.4%
Black	**33%**	12%
International	**2.7%**	5.3%
Two or more	**2.4%**	4.2%
American Indian	**0.5%**	0.6%
Unknown	**2.4%**	4.8%

Share of fall 2024 enrollment by race and ethnicity. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

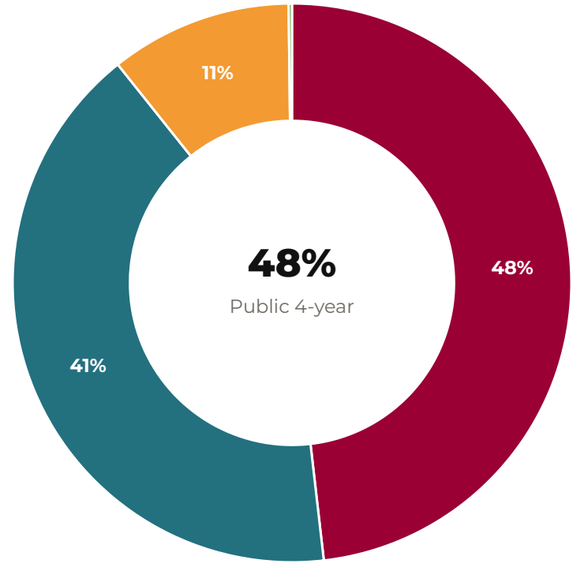
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The rings divide fall 2024 headcount enrollment at Mississippi's degree-granting institutions by race and ethnicity, with the nation for comparison. "International" counts U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, whatever their race; "Unknown" is students whose race was not reported.

THE NUMBERS

- **White**: 53% in fall 2024 (U.S. 45%), down 1.1 points from 54% in fall 2023, and down 0.6 points since fall 2015 (54%).
- **Black**: 33% in fall 2024 (U.S. 12%), unchanged from 33% in fall 2023, and down 3.2 points since fall 2015 (37%).
- **Hispanic**: 4.0% in fall 2024 (U.S. 21%), up 0.3 points from 3.7% in fall 2023, and up 2.0 points since fall 2015 (2.0%).
- **International**: 2.7% in fall 2024 (U.S. 5.3%), up 0.6 points from 2.1% in fall 2023, and up 0.8 points since fall 2015 (1.9%).
- **Two or more**: 2.4% in fall 2024 (U.S. 4.2%), unchanged from 2.4% in fall 2023, and up 0.9 points since fall 2015 (1.5%).

Figure 34 Where Do Students Enroll?



	Share
Public 4-year	**48%**
Public 2-year	**41%**
Private nonprofit	**11%**
For-profit	**0.2%**

Share of fall 2024 enrollment by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

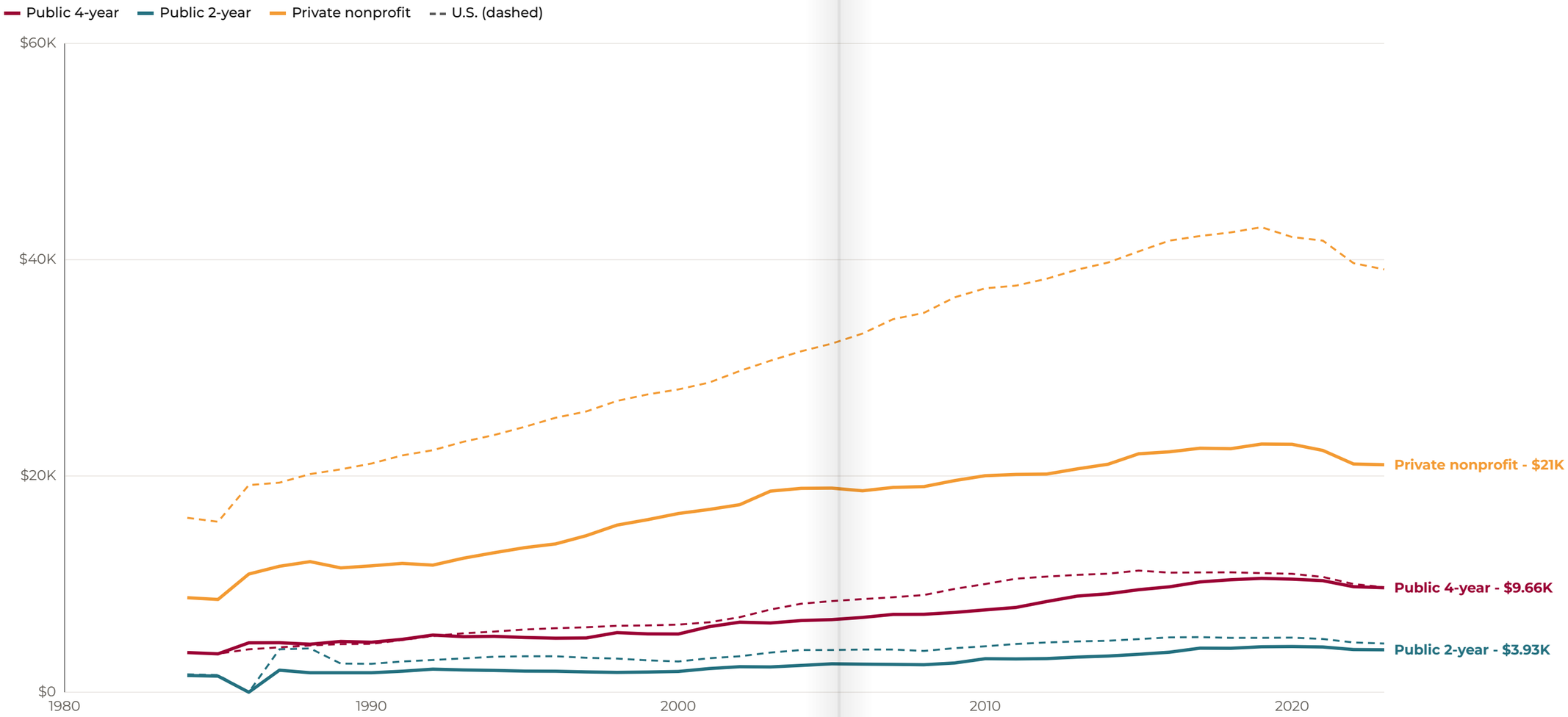
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The ring divides fall 2024 headcount enrollment in Mississippi among public four-year, public two-year, private nonprofit and for-profit institutions.

THE NUMBERS

- **Public 4-year share of enrollment**: 48% in fall 2024, down 0.2 points from 48% in fall 2023, and up 2.0 points since fall 2015 (46%).
- **Public 2-year share of enrollment**: 41% in fall 2024, down 0.2 points from 41% in fall 2023, and down 1.9 points since fall 2015 (43%).
- **Private nonprofit share of enrollment**: 11% in fall 2024, up 0.3 points from 10% in fall 2023, and up 0.8 points since fall 2015 (9.7%).
- **For-profit share of enrollment**: 0.2% in fall 2024, up 0.1 points from 0.1% in fall 2023, and down 0.9 points since fall 2015 (1.1%).

Figure 35 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Mississippi's public four-year institutions are $9.66K (2023, 2024 dollars), close to the U.S. figure ($9.71K); the state ranks 30th of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $10.3K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (30th of 51), and tuition makes up 40% of their core revenue (U.S. 43%).

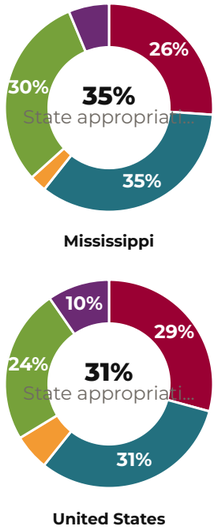
$9.66K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **30th** of 51 · +1.9% since 2015

$10.3K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **30th** of 51 · +0.2% since 2015

40%
Tuition share of public revenue, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **35th** of 51 · +2.4 pp since 2015

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Figure 36 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



	Mississippi	United States
Net tuition	**26%**	29%
State appropriations	**35%**	31%
Local appropriations	**2.6%**	5.6%
Federal grants & appropriations	**30%**	24%
Private gifts & grants	**6.3%**	9.6%

Core revenue per FTE student, public institutions. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The rings divide the core revenue of Mississippi's public institutions per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student by source, with the nation for comparison. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

THE NUMBERS

- **Net tuition per FTE student**: $7.2K in FY2024 (U.S. $8.96K), up 2.6% from $7.02K in FY2023, and up 11% since FY2015 ($6.48K).
- **State appropriations per FTE student**: $9.55K in FY2024 (U.S. $9.64K), up 2.2% from $9.35K in FY2023, and down 0.4% since FY2015 ($9.59K).
- **Local appropriations per FTE student**: $729 in FY2024 (U.S. $1.71K), down 3.6% from $756 in FY2023, and up 9.0% since FY2015 ($669).
- **Federal grants & appropriations per FTE student**: $8.4K in FY2024 (U.S. $7.36K), down 2.7% from $8.63K in FY2023, and up 23% since FY2015 ($6.84K).

Table 5 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Mississippi	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$9.66K**	$9.71K	30th of 51	+1.9%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$10.3K**	$11.4K	30th of 51	+0.2%
Tuition share of public revenue	2024	**40%**	43%	35th of 51	+2.4 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**59%**	65%	33rd of 51	+7.7 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$71.7K**	$106K	50th of 51	−12%

Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Mississippi: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

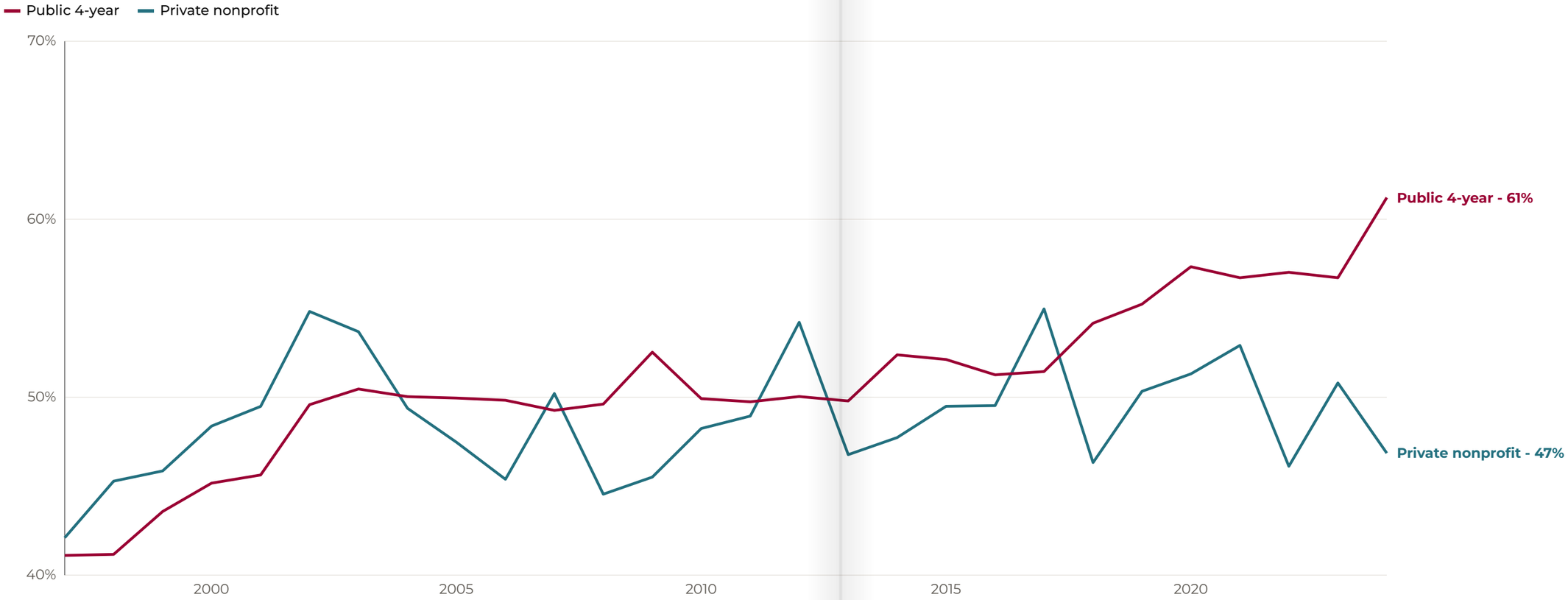
THE NUMBERS

- **In-state tuition, public 4-year**: $9.66K in 2023 (U.S. $9.71K; 30th of 51 states), down 1.0% from $9.76K in 2022, and up 1.9% since 2015 ($9.49K).
- **Appropriations per student**: $10.3K in 2024 (U.S. $11.4K; 30th of 51 states), up 1.7% from $10.1K in 2023, and up 0.2% since 2015 ($10.3K).
- **Tuition share of public revenue**: 40% in 2024 (U.S. 43%; 35th of 51 states), up 0.2 points from 40% in 2023, and up 2.4 points since 2015 (37%).
- **Six-year graduation rate**: 59% in 2024 (U.S. 65%; 33rd of 51 states), up 3.4 points from 56% in 2023, and up 7.7 points since 2015 (52%).

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

Figure 37 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

59% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Mississippi graduated within six years (2024), 5.4 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 33rd of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 61%, private nonprofit 47%. At two-year institutions, 44% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).

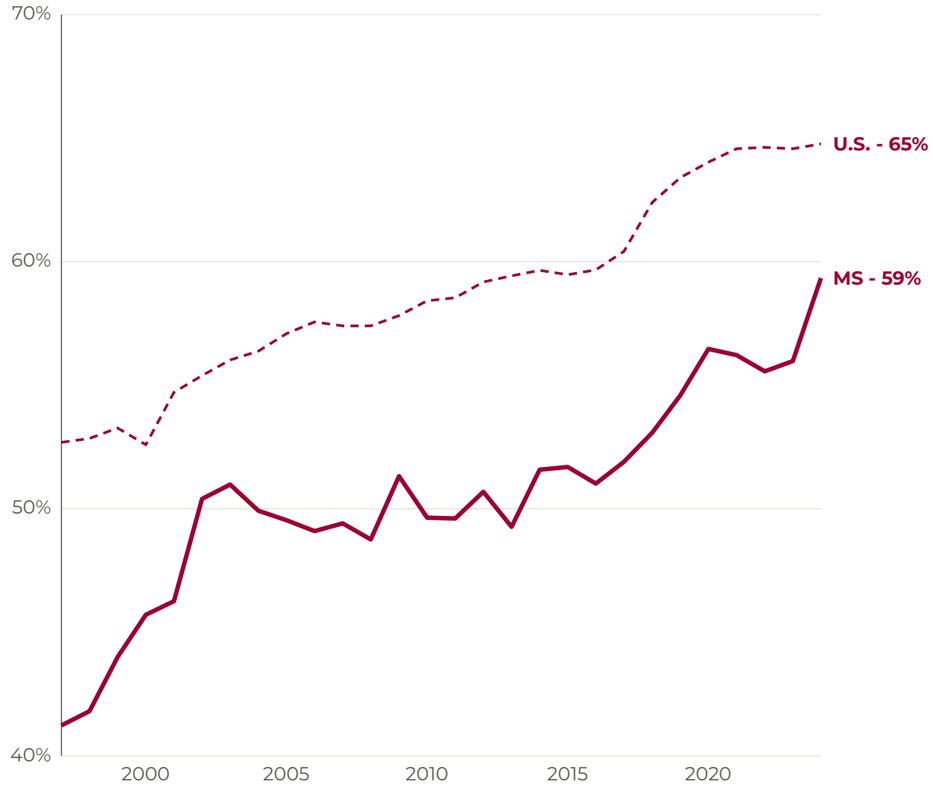
59%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **33rd** of 51 · +7.7 pp since 2015

44%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **18th** of 50 · +15.5 pp since 2015

10.8
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **44th** of 51 · +1.2 since 2015

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Figure 38 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

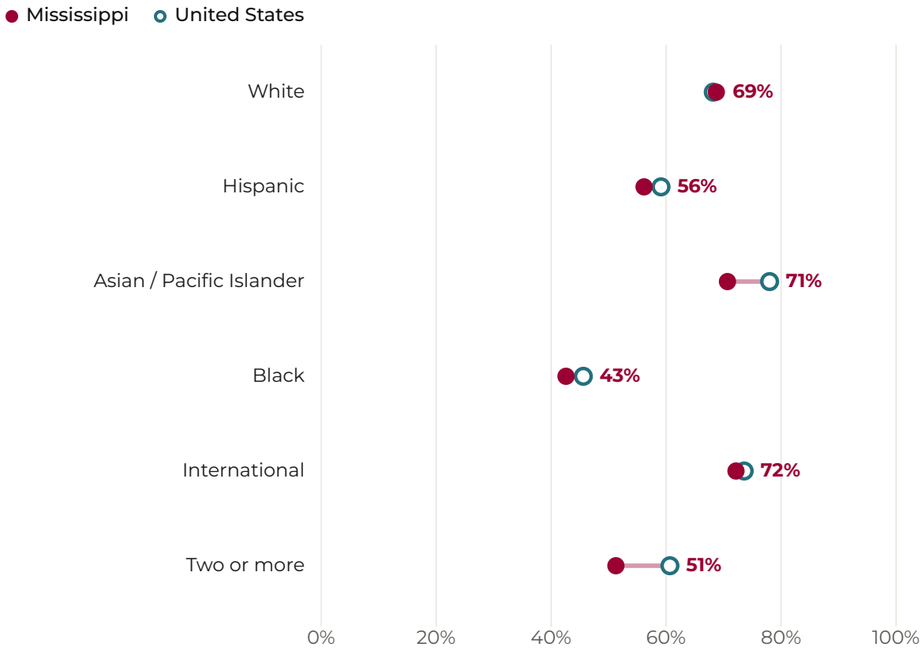
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Mississippi's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

THE NUMBERS

- **Six-year graduation rate**: 59% in 2024 (U.S. 65%), up 3.4 points from 56% in 2023, and up 7.7 points since 2015 (52%).
- **Public 4-year institutions**: 61% in 2024, up 4.5 points from 57% in 2023, and up 9.1 points since 2015 (52%).
- **Private nonprofit institutions**: 47% in 2024, down 3.9 points from 51% in 2023, and down 2.6 points since 2015 (49%).
- **Two-year institutions, completion within 150% of normal time**: 44% in 2024 (U.S. 41%), up 1.8 points from 43% in 2023, and up 15.5 points since 2015 (29%).
- **State rank on the six-year rate**: 59% in 2024 (U.S. 65%; 33rd of 51 states), up 3.4 points from 56% in 2023, and up 7.7 points since 2015 (52%).

Figure 39 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Mississippi's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

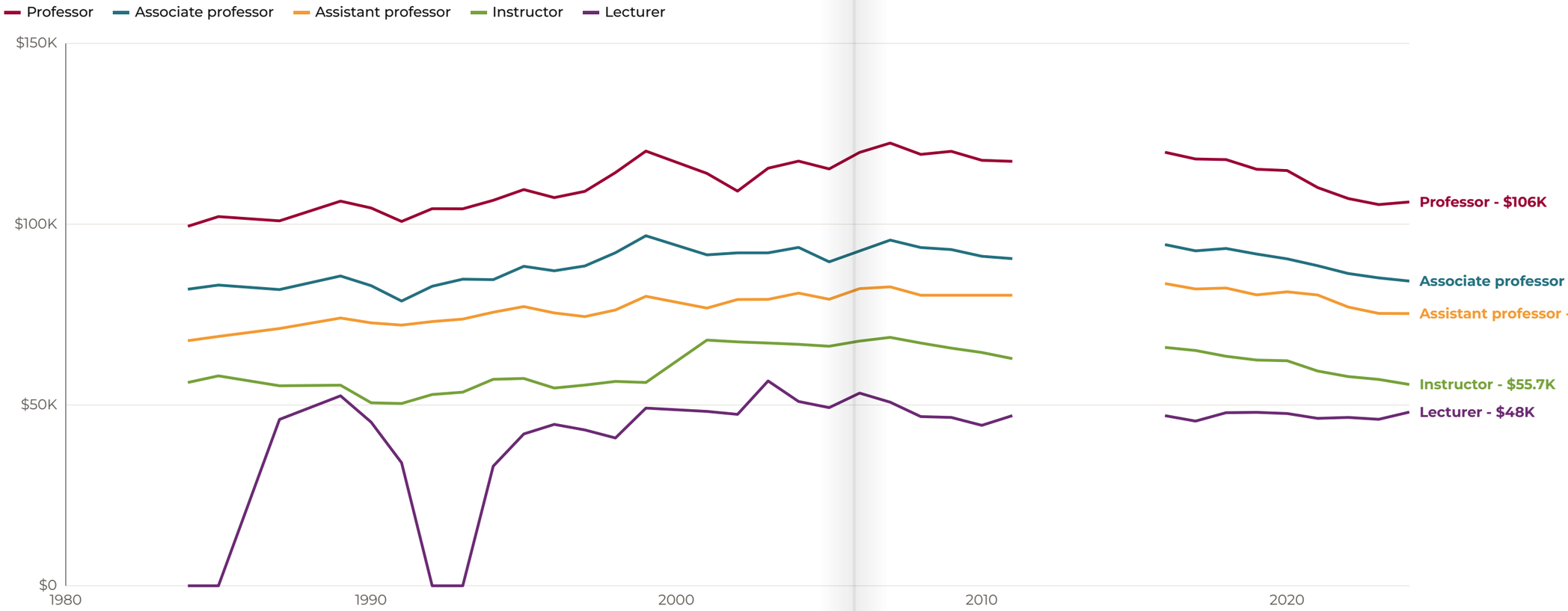
THE NUMBERS

- **White**: 69% in 2024 (U.S. 68%).
- **Hispanic**: 56% in 2024 (U.S. 59%).
- **Asian / Pacific Islander**: 71% in 2024 (U.S. 78%).
- **Black**: 43% in 2024 (U.S. 46%).
- **International**: 72% in 2024 (U.S. 74%).
- **Two or more**: 51% in 2024 (U.S. 61%).

SECTION 15

Faculty

Figure 40 What Do Mississippi's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Mississippi's institutions earned an average of $71.7K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 32% below the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 50th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $106K, associate professors $84.3K, assistant professors $75.3K, instructors $55.7K, lecturers $48K.

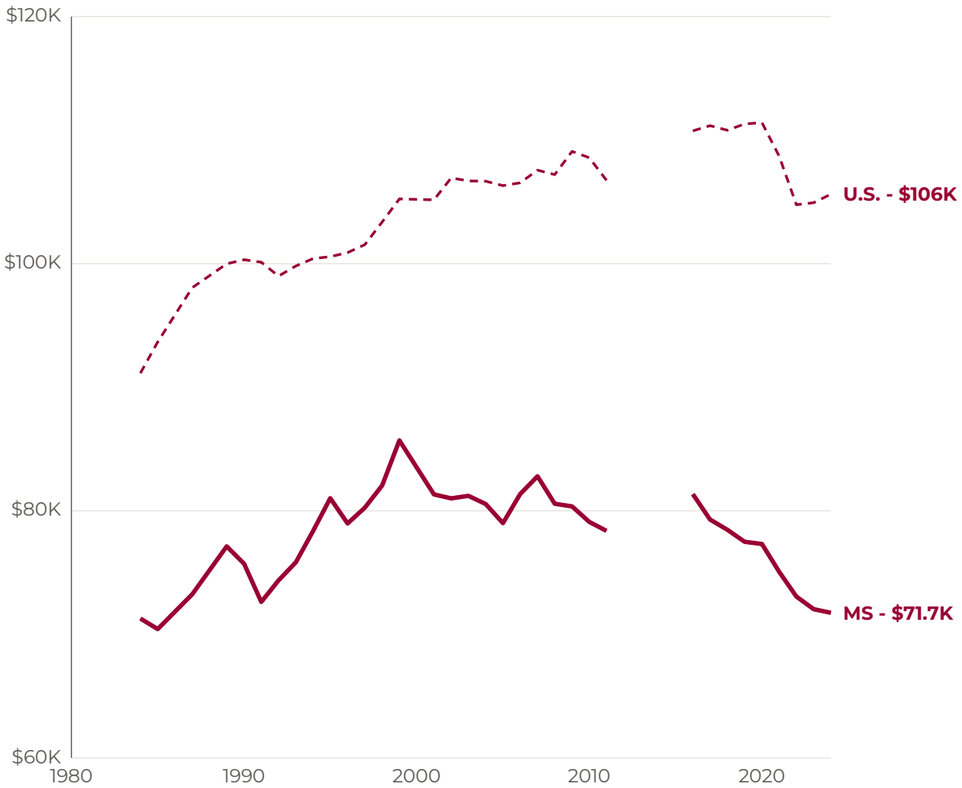
Mississippi's institutions had 7.25K full-time instructional staff in 2024, down 4% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 12% since 2016.

$71.7K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **50th** of 51 · −12% since 2016

Figure 41 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

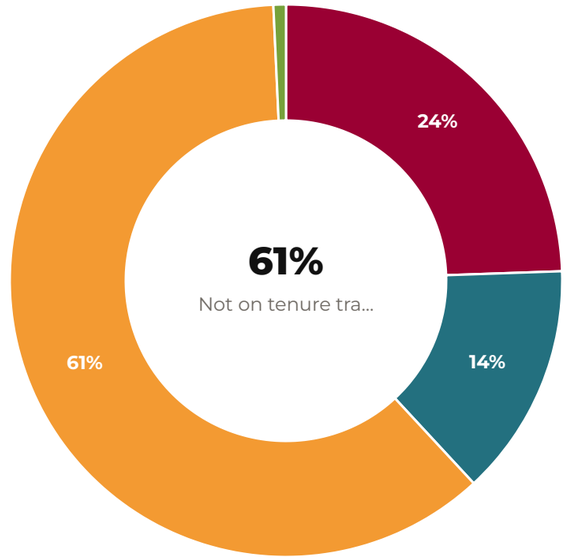
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Mississippi's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

THE NUMBERS

- **Average salary**: $71.7K in 2024 (U.S. $106K), down 0.4% from $72K in 2023, and down 12% since 2016 ($81.3K).
- **State rank on average salary**: $71.7K in 2024 (U.S. $106K; 50th of 51 states), down 0.4% from $72K in 2023, and down 12% since 2016 ($81.3K).
- **Full-time instructional staff**: 7.25K in 2024, up 1.0% from 7.18K in 2023, and down 3.8% since 2015 (7.54K).
- **Professors, average salary**: $106K in 2024, up 0.7% from $105K in 2023, and down 11% since 2016 ($120K).
- **Associate professors, average salary**: $84.3K in 2024, down 1.0% from $85.1K in 2023, and down 11% since 2016 ($94.4K).
- **Assistant professors, average salary**: $75.3K in 2024, down 0.1% from $75.3K in 2023, and down 9.9% since 2016 ($83.6K).

Figure 42 Tenure Status



	Share
Tenured	24%
On tenure track	14%
Not on tenure track	61%
No faculty status	0.7%

Full-time instructional staff, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The ring divides Mississippi's full-time instructional staff in 2024 by tenure status: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

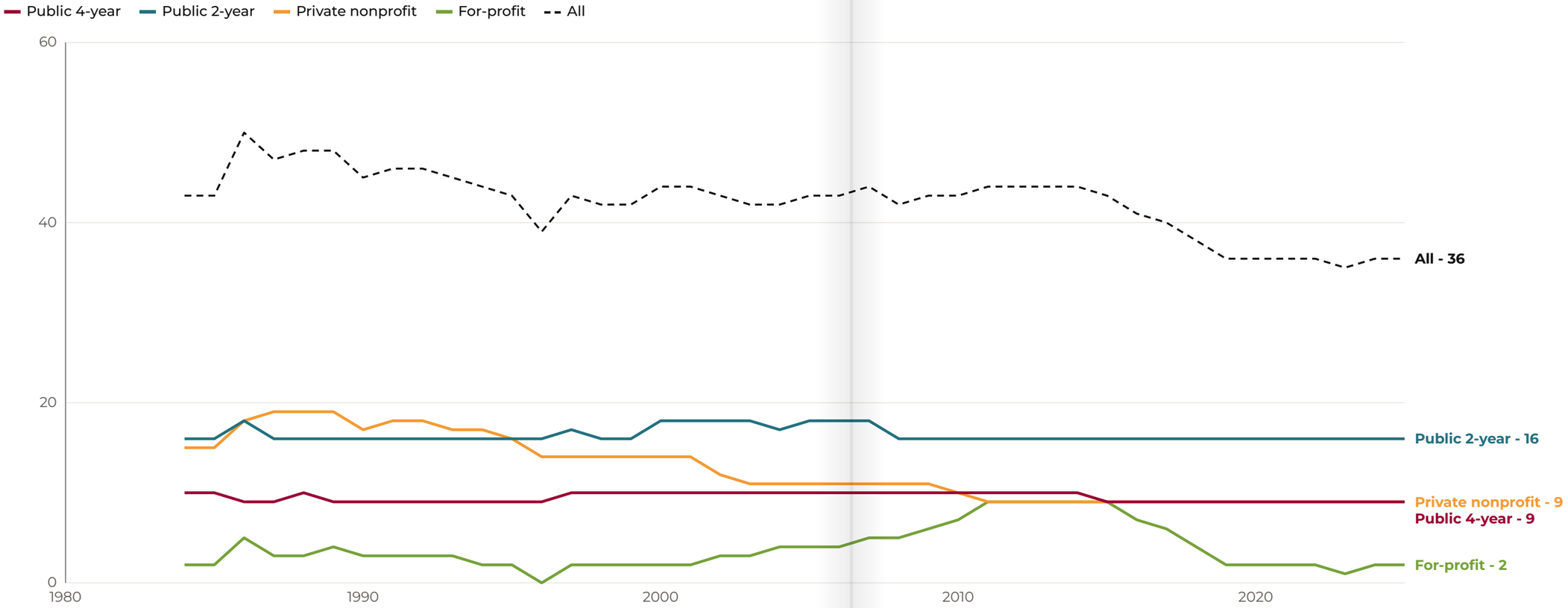
THE NUMBERS

- **Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff**: 24% in 2024, down 0.8 points from 25% in 2023, and down 3.2 points since 2015 (28%).
- **On tenure track, share of full-time instructional staff**: 14% in 2024, up 0.2 points from 13% in 2023, and down 4.0 points since 2015 (18%).
- **Not on tenure track, share of full-time instructional staff**: 61% in 2024, up 0.5 points from 61% in 2023, and up 6.8 points since 2015 (54%).
- **No faculty status, share of full-time instructional staff**: 0.7% in 2024, up 0.1 points from 0.6% in 2023, and up 0.4 points since 2015 (0.3%).

SECTION 16

Institutions

Figure 43 How Many Institutions Does Mississippi Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Mississippi has 34 degree-granting institutions: 9 public 4-year, 16 public 2-year, 9 private nonprofit, 2 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 16% since 2015. 89% of students attend public institutions and 0.2% attend for-profit ones.

89%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **6th** of 51 · +0.1 pp since 2015

0.2%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **41st** of 51 · −0.9 pp since 2015

23%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **28th** of 51 · +11.4 pp since 2015

Table 6 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM master's	Int. share	Intl STEM doctorates	Int. share
Belhaven University Jackson · Private nonprofit	**233**	97%	–	–
Mississippi State University Mississippi State · Public 4-year	**101**	27%	41	42%
University of Southern Mississippi Hattiesburg · Public 4-year	**88**	62%	1	3.8%
University of Mississippi University · Public 4-year	**24**	17%	30	45%
Mississippi Christian University Clinton · Private nonprofit	**23**	36%	–	–
Alcorn State University Alcorn State · Public 4-year	**18**	58%	–	–
Jackson State University Jackson · Public 4-year	**15**	52%	–	–%

Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Institutions in Mississippi ranked by the STEM master's and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

THE NUMBERS

- **Largest**: Belhaven University (233 international STEM master's, – doctorates); Mississippi State University (101 international STEM master's, 41 doctorates); University of Southern Mississippi (88 international STEM master's, 1 doctorates).
- **International STEM master's degrees, all institutions**: 502 in 2025 (U.S. 117K; 33rd of 51 states), up 96% from 256 in 2024, and up 119% since 2015 (229).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 36% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 38th of 51 states), down 10.2 points from 46% in 2024, and down 14.0 points since 2015 (50%).

Table 7 What Are Mississippi's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
University of Mississippi	**26.4K**	11%	492	72%	97%
Mississippi State University	**23.1K**	15%	1.57K	67%	78%
University of Southern Mississippi	**13.2K**	10%	462	49%	99%
Hinds Community College	**8.86K**	–	–	–	–
Mississippi Gulf Coast Community College	**8.69K**	–	–	–	–
Northwest Mississippi Community College	**7.87K**	–	–	–	–
Jackson State University	**6.33K**	7.7%	171	51%	93%
Pearl River Community College	**6.01K**	–	–	–	–
William Carey University	**5.32K**	5.4%	58	60%	60%
Itawamba Community College	**5.14K**	–	–	–	–
Holmes Community College	**5.04K**	–	–	–	–
Jones County Junior College	**4.75K**	–	–	–	–
Belhaven University	**4.21K**	27%	23	49%	50%
Mississippi Christian University	**4.16K**	4.8%	106	59%	29%

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Mississippi's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

THE NUMBERS

- **Largest**: University of Mississippi (26.4K students); Mississippi State University (23.1K students); University of Southern Mississippi (13.2K students).
- **Degree-granting institutions**: 34.
- **Share of students at public institutions**: 89% in 2024 (U.S. 73%; 6th of 51 states), down 0.4 points from 90% in 2023, and up 0.1 points since 2015 (89%).
- **Share at for-profit institutions**: 0.2% in 2024 (U.S. 5.5%; 41st of 51 states), up 0.1 points from 0.1% in 2023, and down 0.9 points since 2015 (1.1%).

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

All dollar values are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts.

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

Source

National Center for Education Statistics, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS): Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions components, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. Department of Homeland Security, SEVIS by the Numbers data mapping tool, 2014–2026. Generated November 2026.

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Mississippi – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	271	**269**[2024]	−1.5 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#35	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	22%	**22%**[2024]	−0.2 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#40	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	234	**239**[2024]	+4.9 ▲	237	−2.5 ▼	#16	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	30%	**38%**[2024]	+8.3 pp ▲	39%	0.0 pp	#31	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	252	**253**[2024]	+1.5 ▲	257	−7.3 ▼	#41	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	20%	**23%**[2024]	+2.7 pp ▲	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#46	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	214	**219**[2024]	+4.4 ▲	214	−7.1 ▼	#9	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**140**[2015]	–	153	–	#46	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$11K	**$11.8K**[2021]	+7.1% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#48	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	81%	**89%**[2022]	+8.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#9	[3]
Public high school graduates	26.7K	**28.6K**[2024]	+6.9% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#35	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$55.7K	**$51.8K**[2022]	−7.0% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#51	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	15.1	**13.0**[2022]	−2.1 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#37	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	487K	**432K**[2024]	−11% ▼	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#35	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	74%	**100%**[2023]	+26.0 pp ▲	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#1	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	1.9%	**3.1%**[2022]	+1.2 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#45	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	0.0%	**0.7%**[2023]	+0.7 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#39	[3]
High schools offering calculus	40%[2016]	**27%**[2024]	−13.1 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#47	[14]
High schools offering physics	54%[2016]	**44%**[2024]	−9.3 pp ▼	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#46	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	83%[2016]	**82%**[2024]	−1.8 pp ▼	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#27	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	85%[2016]	**86%**[2024]	+0.6 pp ▲	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#37	[14]
High schools offering computer science	50%[2021]	**66%**[2024]	+16.4 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#22	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	56%[2016]	**60%**[2024]	+4.1 pp ▲	56%	0.0 pp	#25	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	15%[2021]	**28%**[2024]	+12.4 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#19	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

MISSISSIPPI – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	67%[2016]	**83%[2024]**	+16.0 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#16	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	8.2[2016]	**12.6[2024]**	+4.5 ▲	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#37	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	1.2[2016]	**0.7[2024]**	−0.6 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#51	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	3.2[2016]	**2.4[2024]**	−0.8 ▼	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#48	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	24.8[2016]	**35.5[2024]**	+10.6 ▲	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#3	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	6.9[2016]	**6.3[2024]**	−0.6 ▼	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#19	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	52%	**42%[2025]**	−10.2 pp ▼	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#5	[15]
Fall enrollment	174K	**164K[2024]**	−5.7% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#34	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	89%	**89%[2024]**	+0.1 pp ▲	73%	0.0 pp	#6	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	1.1%	**0.2%[2024]**	−0.9 pp ▼	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#41	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	24%	**28%[2024]**	+4.4 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#47	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	12%	**13%[2024]**	+1.7 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#35	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	12%	**23%[2024]**	+11.4 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#28	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	446	**469[2025]**	+5.2% ▲	59K	+7.3% ▲	#33	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	243	**280[2025]**	+15% ▲	44.4K	+14% ▲	#35	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	0.8%	**0.8%[2025]**	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#33	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	44	**44[2025]**	+0.0%	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#39	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	23	**24[2025]**	+4.3% ▲	5.07K	+33% ▲	#35	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	5.1	**5.2[2025]**	+0.1 ▲	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#30	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	17%	**21%[2025]**	+4.0 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#35	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	1.1%	**2.9%[2025]**	+1.8 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#49	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	5.9%	**7.9%[2025]**	+2.0 pp ▲	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#14	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	0.9%	**0.5%[2025]**	−0.4 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#48	[4]

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MISSISSIPPI – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	5.9%	**6.2%**[2025]	+0.3 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#30	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	2.0%	**1.3%**[2025]	−0.7 pp ▼	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#22	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	12%	**13%**[2025]	+0.3 pp ▲	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#21	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	19%	**20%**[2025]	+1.8 pp ▲	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#21	[4]
STEM share of master's	17%	**17%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#32	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	2.9%	**6.4%**[2025]	+3.5 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#32	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	2.7%	**3.3%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#41	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.7%	**0.3%**[2025]	−0.4 pp ▼	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#48	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	7.0%	**5.0%**[2025]	−2.1 pp ▼	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#4	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	3.1%	**2.0%**[2025]	−1.1 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#6	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	14%	**11%**[2025]	−3.2 pp ▼	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#45	[4]
Share of master's in business	19%	**20%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#29	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	29%	**20%**[2025]	−9.0 pp ▼	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#49	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	2.6%	**1.4%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#44	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	9.8%	**6.3%**[2025]	−3.5 pp ▼	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#47	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	1.0%	**1.3%**[2025]	+0.3 pp ▲	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#36	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	5.6%	**4.3%**[2025]	−1.3 pp ▼	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#48	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	6.8%	**4.6%**[2025]	−2.2 pp ▼	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#42	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	12%	**18%**[2025]	+5.6 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#14	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	3.8%	**12%**[2025]	+7.7 pp ▲	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#6	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	9.5	**10.8**[2025]	+1.2 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#44	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	1.2%[2016]	**1.5%**[2024]	+0.3 pp ▲	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#42	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	229	**502**[2025]	2.19× ▲	117K	2.18× ▲	#33	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	0.4%	**0.4%**[2025]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#33	[4]

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MISSISSIPPI – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	1.1%	**1.4%**[2024]	+0.2 pp ▲	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#46	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	7.9%	**12%**[2024]	+3.8 pp ▲	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#29	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	1.6%	**1.6%**[2025]	0.0 pp	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#47	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	3.4%	**2.7%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#43	[4]
International share of all master's	7.3%	**11%**[2025]	+3.9 pp ▲	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#37	[4]
International share of STEM master's	27%	**48%**[2025]	+21.7 pp ▲	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#21	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	85%	**87%**[2025]	+2.4 pp ▲	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#4	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	28%	**39%**[2025]	+11.7 pp ▲	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#27	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	26%	**28%**[2022]	+1.3 pp ▲	48%	−0.3 pp ▼	#26	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	4.2%	**18%**[2025]	+14.0 pp ▲	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#25	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	22%	**25%**[2025]	+3.1 pp ▲	33%	+3.6 pp ▲	#31	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	22%	**14%**[2025]	−7.8 pp ▼	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#47	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	50%	**36%**[2025]	−14.0 pp ▼	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#38	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	63%	**35%**[2025]	−27.0 pp ▼	55%	−1.0 pp ▼	#38	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	38%	**24%**[2025]	−13.7 pp ▼	23%	−4.3 pp ▼	#22	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	59%	**42%**[2025]	−16.8 pp ▼	38%	−1.1 pp ▼	#16	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	3.71K	**9.84K**[2026]	2.65× ▲	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#27	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.3%	**0.8%**[2026]	+0.5 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#27	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	18%	**60%**[2026]	+41.6 pp ▲	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#1	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	15%	**1.8%**[2026]	−12.8 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#51	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	33%	**65%**[2026]	+32.7 pp ▲	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#1	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	147	**141**[2026]	−4.1% ▼	219	−2.7% ▼	#39	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	1.74K	**2.41K**[2026]	+39% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#40	[20]
Active STEM master's students	558	**675**[2026]	+21% ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#41	[20]

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MISSISSIPPI – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
Active STEM doctoral students	635	**896**[2026]	+41% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#34	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	56%	**55%**[2026]	−1.8 pp ▼	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#31	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	1.52K[2017]	**1.62K**[2024]	+6.5% ▲	–	–	#37	[1]
Economic contribution of international students	$84.6M[2018]	**$92.1M**[2024]	+8.9% ▲	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#40	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	863[2018]	**622**[2024]	−28% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#40	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.2%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#48	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.2%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#43	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.1%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#51	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	940	**437**[2025]	−54% ▼	275K	−14% ▼	#51	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	4.04K	**3.91K**[2016]	−3.3% ▼	620K	+0.4% ▲	#35	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	884	**899**[2016]	+1.7% ▲	241K	+2.3% ▲	#38	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	22%	**23%**[2016]	+1.1 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#43	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	33%	**34%**[2016]	+0.9 pp ▲	57%	0.0 pp	#47	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	111	**108**[2016]	−2.7% ▼	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#41	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	59%	**57%**[2016]	−2.1 pp ▼	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#19	[9]
University R&D spending	$408M	**$669M**[2024]	+64% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#35	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.6%	**0.6%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#35	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	48%	**53%**[2024]	+5.0 pp ▲	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#24	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	5.5%	**0.8%**[2024]	−4.7 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#50	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	23%	**18%**[2024]	−4.4 pp ▼	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#3	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science	$14.1M	**$18.5M**[2024]	+31% ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#38	[6]
University R&D in engineering	$52.9M	**$98.9M**[2024]	+87% ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#35	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	7.12K	**9.14K**[2024]	+28% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#32	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state	$489M	**$479M**[2024]	−2.0% ▼	$193B	+53% ▲	#39	[8]

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MISSISSIPPI – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state	$114M	**$190M[2024]**	+67% ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#38	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state	$242M	**$153M[2024]**	−37% ▼	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#36	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state	$50.8M	**$67.5M[2024]**	+33% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#44	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state	$64.5M	**$98.1M[2025]**	+52% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#45	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state	$91.5M	**$75M[2026]**	−18% ▼	$59.3B	+59% ▲	#32	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$39K[2020]	**$40.7K[2022]**	+4.4% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#50	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$41K[2025]**	–	$47.5K	–	#51	[15]
Median debt of completers	$19.5K	**$18.8K[2024]**	−3.8% ▼	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#32	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$66.2K[2025]**	–	$68.2K	–	#29	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$46.4K[2025]**	–	$51.9K	–	#42	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$60.2K[2025]**	–	$68.1K	–	#45	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$86.6K[2025]**	–	$91.6K	–	#25	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	52%	**59%[2024]**	+7.7 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#33	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	29%	**44%[2024]**	+15.5 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#18	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$9.49K	**$9.66K[2023]**	+1.9% ▲	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#30	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$10.3K	**$10.3K[2024]**	+0.2% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#30	[4]
Tuition share of core revenue, public institutions	37%	**40%[2024]**	+2.4 pp ▲	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#35	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$81.3K[2016]	**$71.7K[2024]**	−12% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#50	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	21%	**21%[2016]**	+0.6 pp ▲	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#46	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	35%	**36%[2016]**	+0.8 pp ▲	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#40	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	13%	**13%[2016]**	+0.2 pp ▲	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#47	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	15%	**16%[2016]**	+1.2 pp ▲	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#46	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	0.44	**0.45[2016]**	0.0	1.00	0.0	#46	[21]

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MISSISSIPPI – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	145	**158**[2016]	+9.0% ▲	41.2K	+51% ▲	#37	[21]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	−9.9	**−1.1**[2025]	+8.8 ▲	–	–	#30	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	−2.37K	**−461**[2025]	– ▲	–	–	#35	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	2.7%	**2.1%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	–	–	#40	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	3.7%	**2.2%**[2025]	−1.5 pp ▼	–	–	#43	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	983	**2.32K**[2025]	2.36× ▲	–	–	#37	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	76%[2016]	**70%**[2024]	−6.8 pp ▼	–	–	#29	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	+14[2016]	**+23**[2024]	+8.8 ▲	–	–	#11	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	7.0%[2016]	**9.4%**[2022]	+2.3 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#51	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	967	**931**[2025]	−3.7% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#42	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.1%	**0.1%**[2025]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#42	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	60%	**45%**[2025]	−14.9 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#43	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars	$65.3K	**$78K**[2025]	+19% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#47	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	28%	**12%**[2025]	−15.6 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#36	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	89	**163**[2025]	+83% ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#44	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	20%	**11%**[2024]	−9.1 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#46	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	5.1%	**8.2%**[2024]	+3.2 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#30	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	34%	**18%**[2024]	−15.4 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#42	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	31%	**15%**[2025]	−16.0 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#46	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars	$59.8K	**$58.8K**[2025]	−1.6% ▼	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#35	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	1.59K	**2.08K**[2024]	+31% ▲	1.36M	+30% ▲	#43	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.2%	**0.2%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#43	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	946	**1.33K**[2024]	+41% ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#43	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.1%	**0.2%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#43	[16]

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MISSISSIPPI – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.2%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#38	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#45	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#48	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.0%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#46	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	149	**169**[2026]	+13% ▲	127K	+14% ▲	#44	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	147	**284**[2026]	+93% ▲	268K	+52% ▲	#43	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.1%	**0.1%**[2026]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#44	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	9.1%	**3.4%**[2026]	−5.7 pp ▼	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#28	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	55%	**60%**[2026]	+5.3 pp ▲	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#1	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	21%	**5.3%**[2026]	−16.2 pp ▼	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#50	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	62%	**54%**[2026]	−7.9 pp ▼	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#10	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	39.7K	**60K**[2024]	+51% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#39	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	3.3%	**4.5%**[2024]	+1.3 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#51	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	4.0%	**6.3%**[2024]	+2.3 pp ▲	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#46	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	8.2%[2023]	**14%**[2024]	+5.7 pp ▲	41%	+0.9 pp ▲	#43	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	2.5%	**3.8%**[2024]	+1.3 pp ▲	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#45	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	2.5%	**3.3%**[2024]	+0.8 pp ▲	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#41	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	2.4%	**3.0%**[2025]	+0.5 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#49	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	3.8%	**7.3%**[2025]	+3.5 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#47	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	35K	**41.3K**[2025]	+18% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#40	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	0.53	**0.53**[2025]	0.0	1.00	0.0	#51	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal	$68.1K	**$86.1K**[2025]	+26% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#51	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal	$80.4K[2019]	**$95.3K**[2025]	+19% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#50	[10]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

MISSISSIPPI – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
Software developer jobs	1.74K	**1.88K**[2025]	+8.0% ▲	1.69M	+48% ▲	#46	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal	$37.6K	**$50.8K**[2025]	+35% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#51	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	47	**43**[2025]	−8.6% ▼	135K	−0.6% ▼	#48	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#48	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	8.5%	**6.4%**[2025]	−2.1 pp ▼	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#51	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	19%	**17%**[2025]	−2.1 pp ▼	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#25	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	2.1%	**2.1%**[2025]	0.0 pp	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#10	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	7.7%	**7.5%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#48	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

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